Impressipies · Illustrations & empty states (IMP-19)

One pie mascot, five faces, five scenes: empty list, all done, no recipes yet, offline and error. Drawn from IMP-14 tokens as inline SVG so they recolour in light and dark. Shown inside the IMP-15 list, card and sheet shells on iPhone, web (phone, tablet, desktop) and Apple Watch, at the IMP-16 and IMP-17 sizes. Designed in Claude Code (HTML, rendered to PDF).

Pages

- 2 · States at a glance: copy, action, accessibility label
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- 4 · Scenes: five illustrations, light and dark
- 5 · Construction, sizes, rules
- 6 to 9 · iPhone: empty list, all done and no recipes, offline and error, sheet and Dynamic Type
- 10 to 14 · Web: one page per state, desktop, tablet and phone
- 15 · Web: add-to-list dialog and sheet
- 16 · Apple Watch (41, 45, 49 mm, dark only)
- 17 · Open questions
- 18 · Handoff: how to export the SVGs

Decisions made here

- **The pie is the only character.** Scalloped mustard crust, rhubarb filling, one leaf at 1 o'clock. Five faces carry the mood. Never a pattern, texture or repeat.
- **Five scenes** = pie + one prop: basket (empty list), check badge (all done), blank recipe card (no recipes), crossed-out cloud and zz (offline), alert badge (error).
- **Only IMP-14 colours.** Category colours, neutrals, accent. No success, warning, danger or info in artwork: done is leaf, offline is sky, error is tomato.
- **Copy leads, art supports.** Headline, one line of body, one pill button. Errors never blame the person.
- **Offline is only a full state when nothing is cached.** With a cache it stays the IMP-16 banner and clock glyph.
- Add bar stays where the library shows it (empty list, all done); it is absent on offline and error because no list is loaded.

Palette used

- Crust `cat-mustard`, filling `accent`, face `on-accent`, cheeks `accent-soft`, leaf `cat-leaf`.
- Props: `cat-cocoa`, `cat-leaf`, `cat-sky`, `cat-tomato`, `cat-berry`, `surface-2`, `ink-muted`.
- Every coloured shape is at least 3:1 against `bg`, `surface` and `surface-2` in both modes (lowest: sky 3.1 and leaf 3.2 in light).
- Radius language 8 / 12 / 20 / pill; 4 pt grid; Nunito display, system-ui body.

States at a glance

Copy, primary action and the accessibility label for each state. iOS and web copy match unless a row says otherwise. Watch copy is shorter (page 16).

STATE · WHERE	HEADLINE	BODY	PRIMARY ACTION	ILLUSTRATION LABEL
Empty list list shell, under the add bar	This list is empty	Type “milk 2L”. Use return or commas for several.	Add an item	Pie peeking out of an empty basket
No lists yet Lists home, sheet shell	No lists yet	Make one for each shop.	New list	Pie peeking out of an empty basket
All done card shell, under the add bar	Everything is in the cart	Nice work, team.	Clear checked (9)	Happy pie with a green check mark
No recipes yet iOS Recipes tab (read only)	No recipes yet	Recipes you add on the web or through your AI show up here.	Open on the web	Pie looking at a blank recipe card
No recipes yet (web) web recipe grid	No recipes yet	Ask your AI to add one, or add one yourself.	New recipe then “Connect your AI”	Pie looking at a blank recipe card
Offline, nothing cached iOS Lists, first launch	You’re offline	Connect to the internet to load your lists for the first time.	Try again	Sleeping pie beside a crossed-out cloud
Offline (web) web Recipes, no cache	You’re offline	Recipes need a connection. Your lists still work offline.	Try again then “Go to Lists”	Sleeping pie beside a crossed-out cloud
Error loading card shell, list detail	Couldn’t load Costco	That’s on us, not you. Your list is safe.	Try again	Dizzy pie with an alert badge

What each action does

- **Add an item:** focuses the add bar and raises the keyboard; the button hides once the keyboard is up.
- **Clear checked:** the IMP-16 confirm, then toast with Undo.
- **New recipe / New list:** the existing editor or sheet.
- **Try again:** retries the request; the button shows an ellipsis while loading.

Accessibility

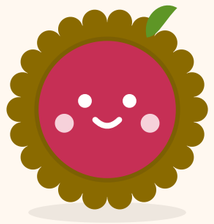
- Each SVG is `role="img"` with the label above, 8 words or fewer, naming what is drawn, never the colour.
- Reading order: illustration, headline, body, button. The headline is a heading (level 2 on web).
- The label carries no information the headline lacks, so it can be hidden without loss (see open questions).
- Reduce Motion: artwork is static. Nothing here animates (IMP-18 decides idle motion).

Tone

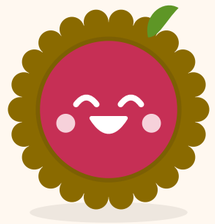
- Plain and warm, no puns, no exclamation marks.
- Error and offline say what happened and that the data is safe. “That’s on us, not you.”
- Reference ids are small and mono so support can ask for them.
- Copy new to this ticket: “This list is empty”, “That’s on us, not you.”, “Error 500 · ref 7F3A”, “Nothing to get”.

Mascot sheet: the pie, five faces

Same body in every pose; only the face changes. Light on cream, dark on warm brown-black. The leaf sits at 1 o'clock and never moves. The ground shadow is `ink` at 8%.



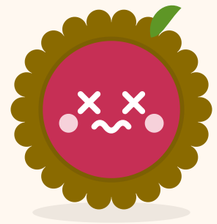
Hello
default; empty list, first run



Happy
success; all done



Sleepy
offline, waiting



Dizzy
something broke



Curious
looking for something; no recipes



Hello
default; empty list, first run



Happy
success; all done



Sleepy
offline, waiting



Dizzy
something broke



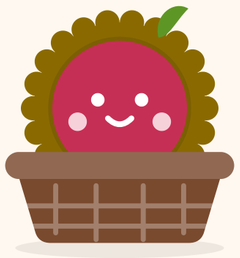
Curious
looking for something; no recipes

Glyph sizes `no props, no cheeks, no leaf under 56`



Scenes: five illustrations

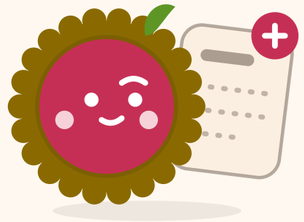
The pie plus one prop, drawn on a 200 × 170 board. Props are category colours, so they recolour with the theme. Light on top, dark below.



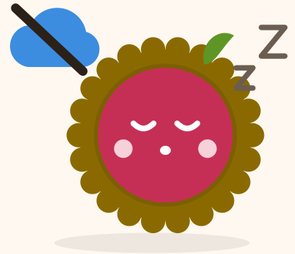
Empty list
Pie peeking out of an empty basket



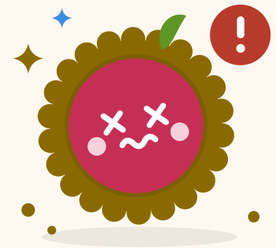
All done
Happy pie with a green check mark



No recipes yet
Pie looking at a blank recipe card



Offline, nothing cached
Sleeping pie beside a crossed-out cloud



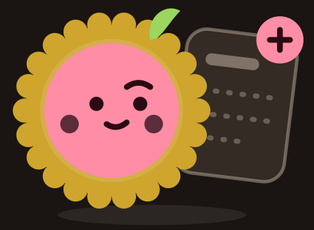
Error loading
Dizzy pie with an alert badge



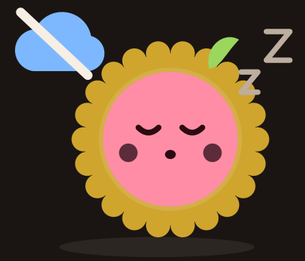
Empty list
Pie peeking out of an empty basket



All done
Happy pie with a green check mark



No recipes yet
Pie looking at a blank recipe card



Offline, nothing cached
Sleeping pie beside a crossed-out cloud



Error loading
Dizzy pie with an alert badge

Construction, sizes and rules

Layers map to tokens one-to-one, so web can recolour with CSS variables and Apple targets get two exported appearances from the same file.

Layers to tokens

- **`cat-mustard`** · crust: 22 scallops r 7.2 on a r 51 disc
- **`accent`** · filling r 40, inner ring is ink at 14%
- **`on-accent`** · eyes and mouth, 3.4 stroke, round caps
- **`accent-soft`** · cheeks r 5.5
- **`cat-leaf`** · leaf; also the done badge
- **`cat-cocoa`** · basket (empty list)
- **`cat-sky`** · cloud (offline), sparkle
- **`cat-tomato`** · alert badge (error)
- **`cat-berry`** · sparkle accent
- **`surface-2 + ink-muted`** · recipe card, z marks, slash is ink

Sizes

- **Hero** 148 to 176 wide on a bare list shell; 128 to 168 inside a card.
- **Compact** 96 to 120 in sheets and on small screens.
- **Accessibility sizes** (Dynamic Type from xxxLarge up): 72 wide, still above the headline.
- **Glyph** 48 (inline), 40 to 50 (watch), 32 minimum. Below 56 drop leaf and cheeks; below 40 never use the scene props.
- Illustration sits 12 to 16 above the headline; the headline sits on the 4 pt grid; the button is 50 pt on iOS, 44 px on web and watch.
- The art never exceeds one third of the screen height, and never pushes the add bar down.
- One mascot per screen. Not in toasts, banners, rows or tabs.

Do and don’t

Do use a face that matches the state, and the prop for that state.

Do keep shapes rounded: 8 / 12 / 20 / pill, round caps and joins.

Do keep the illustration beside real copy and a real button.

Don’t tile, crop or fade the pie into a background. It is a character, not a texture.

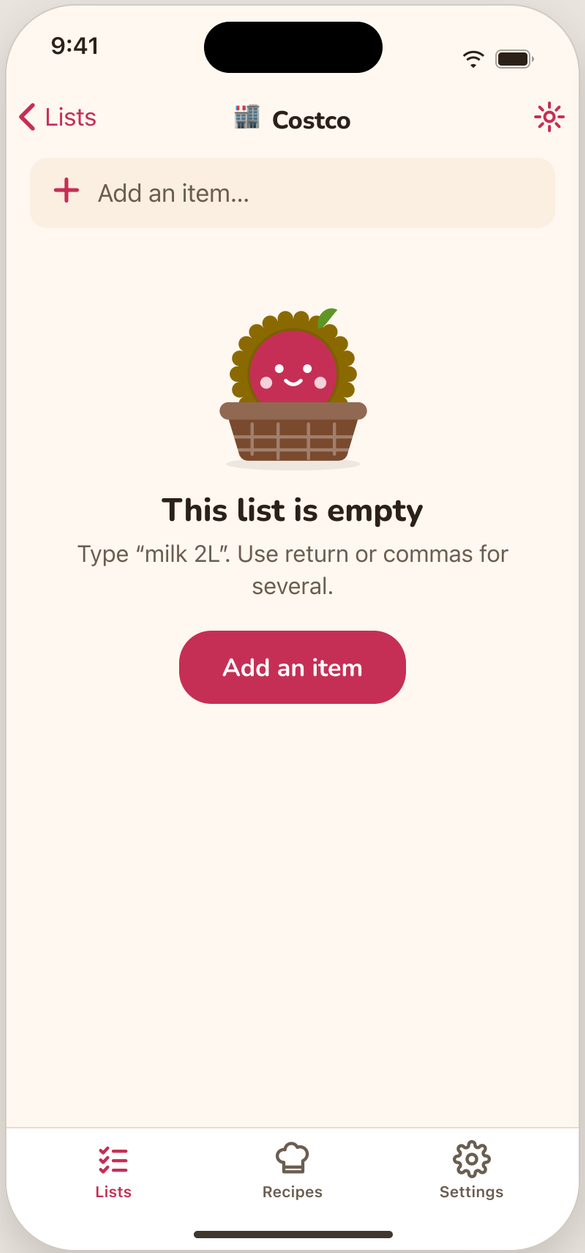
Don’t recolour the crust or filling per list or category.

Don’t use the mascot for validation errors, destructive confirms or loading.

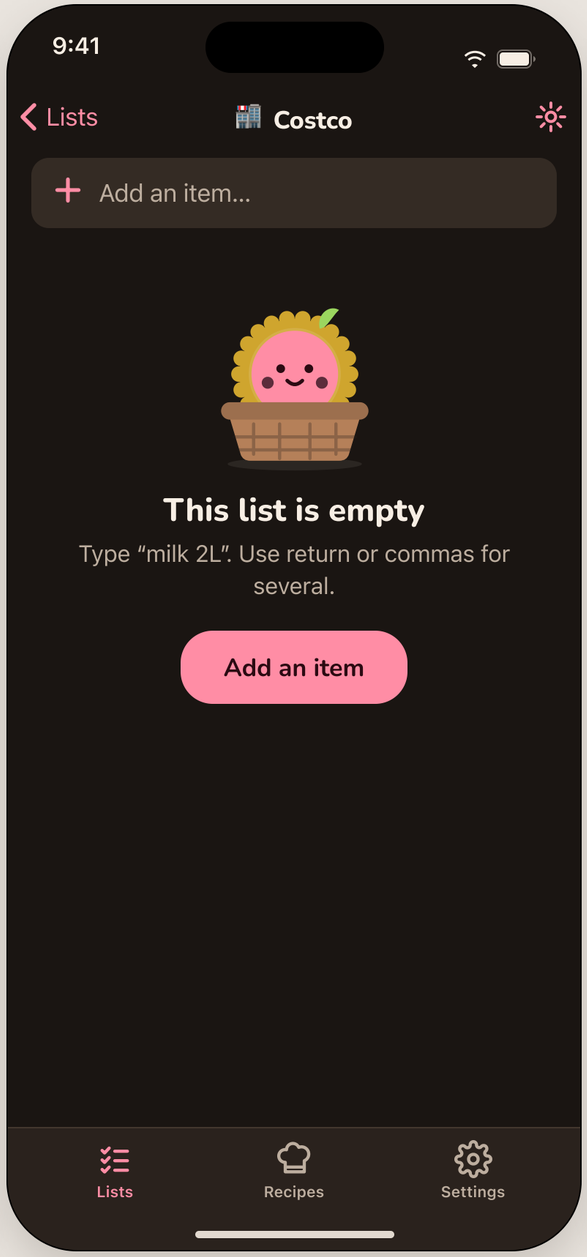
Don’t add new hues, gradients, outlines or drop shadows. Dark has no shadows.

iPhone · Empty list and no lists yet

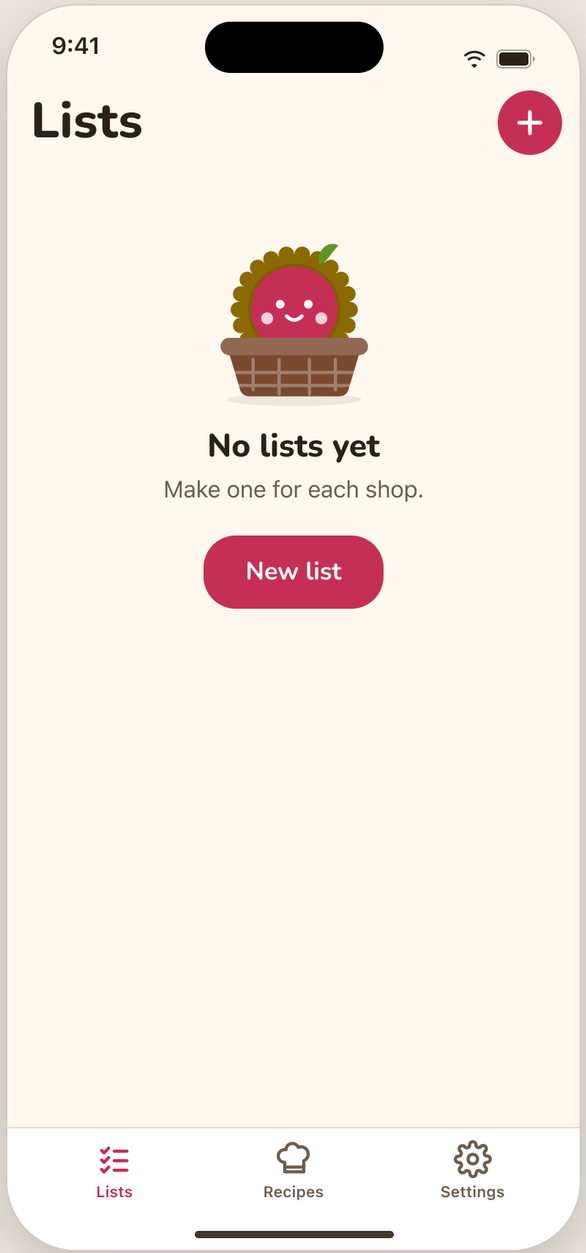
Empty list keeps the add bar at the top; the pie sits below it with the old hint as body. “No lists yet” replaces the emoji disc on Lists home. Both are bare in the shell, no card, so the screen stays quiet.



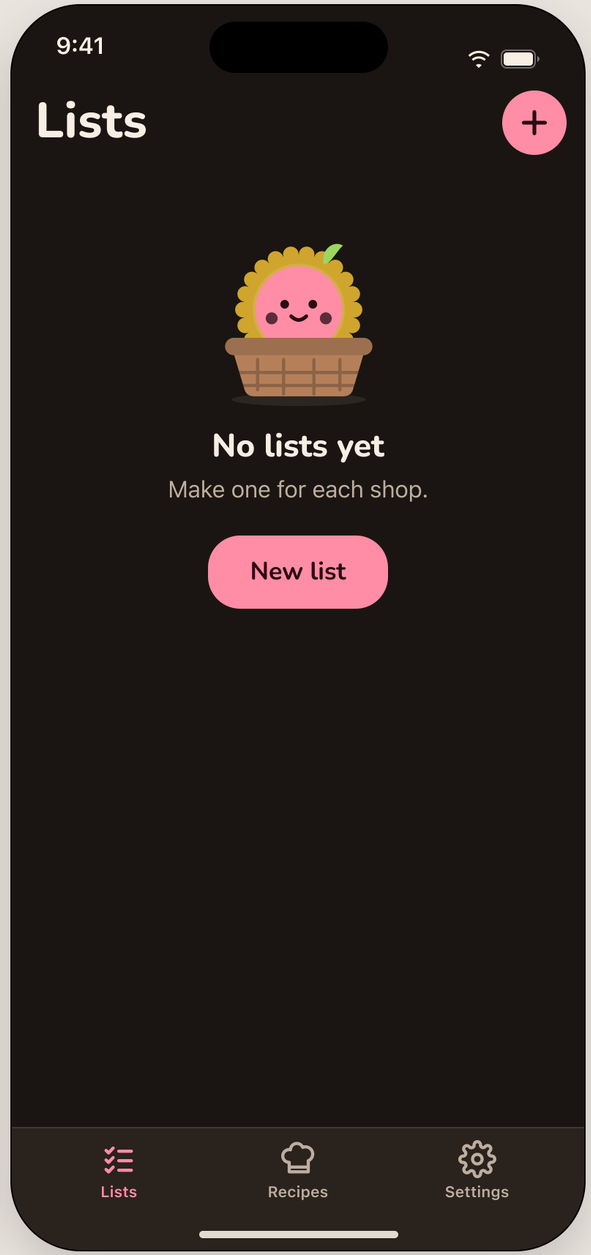
I4 List detail / empty · Light



I4 List detail / empty · Dark



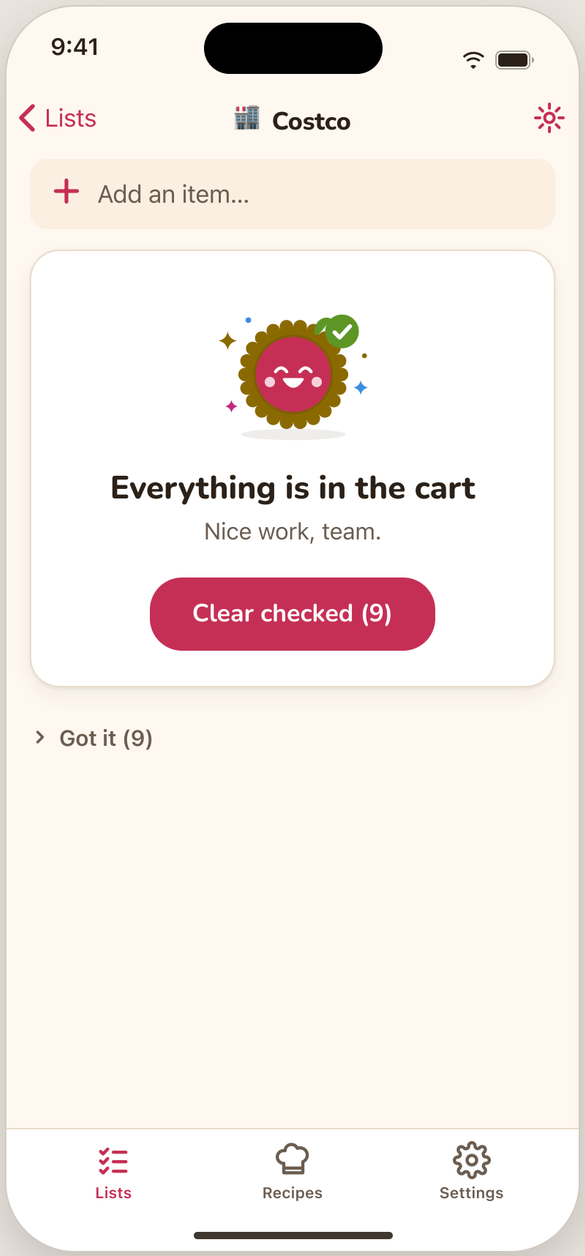
I1 Lists home / no lists yet · Light



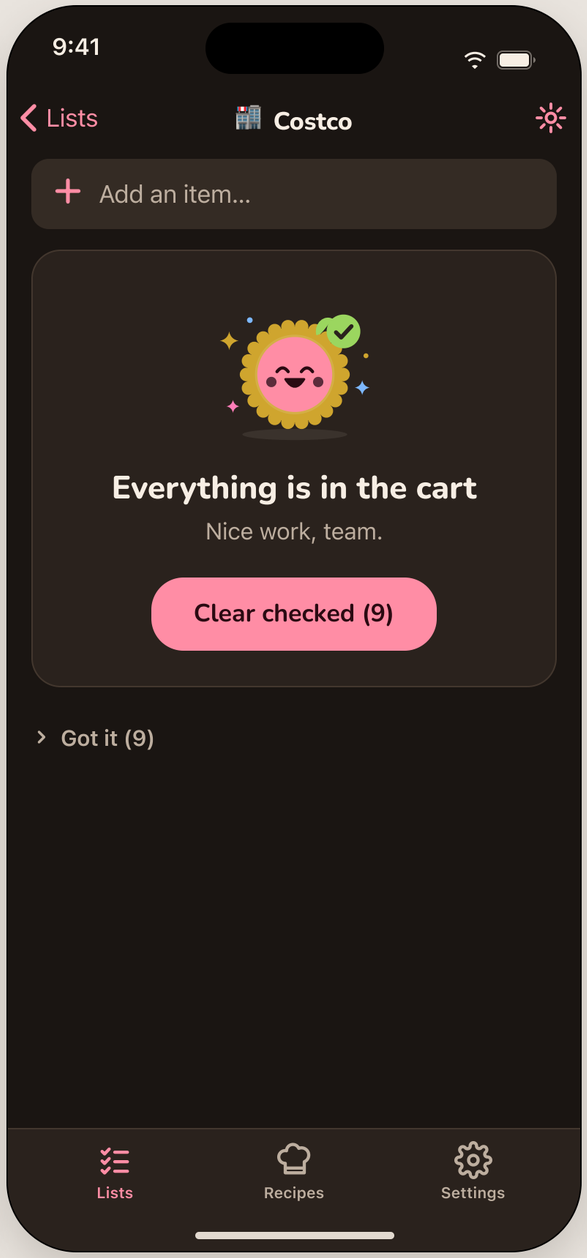
I1 Lists home / no lists yet · Dark

iPhone · All done and no recipes yet

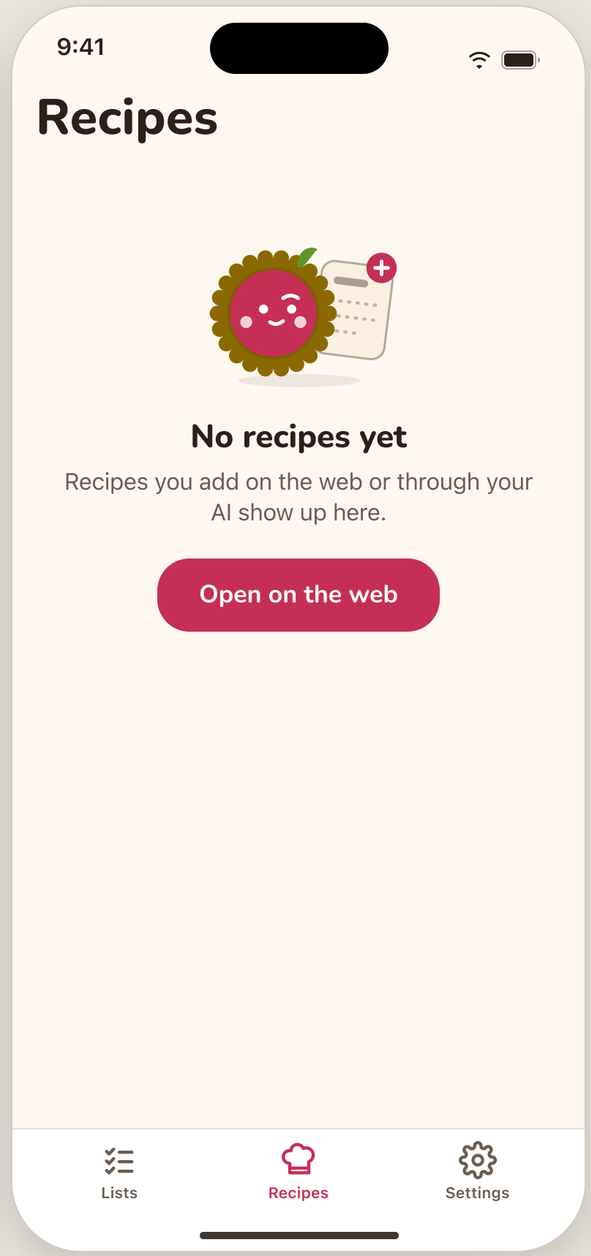
All done lives in a 20 pt card under the add bar, with the one useful action (Clear checked) as the button and Got it collapsed below. Recipes on iPhone is read and cook, so the action points to the web.



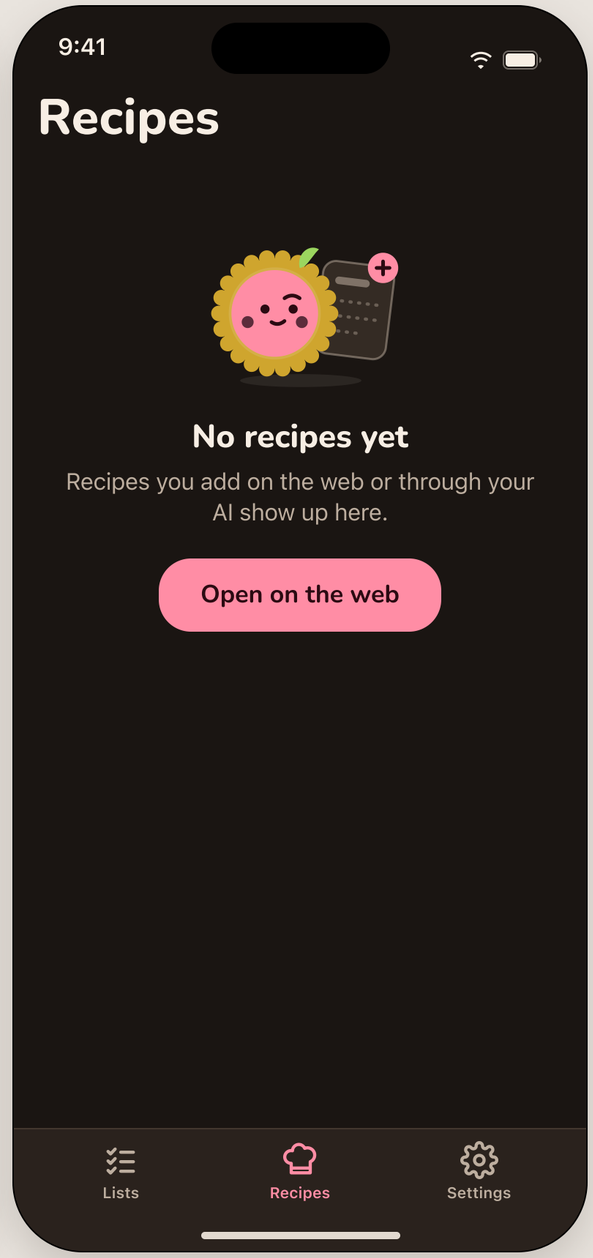
I4 List detail / all done · Light



I4 List detail / all done · Dark



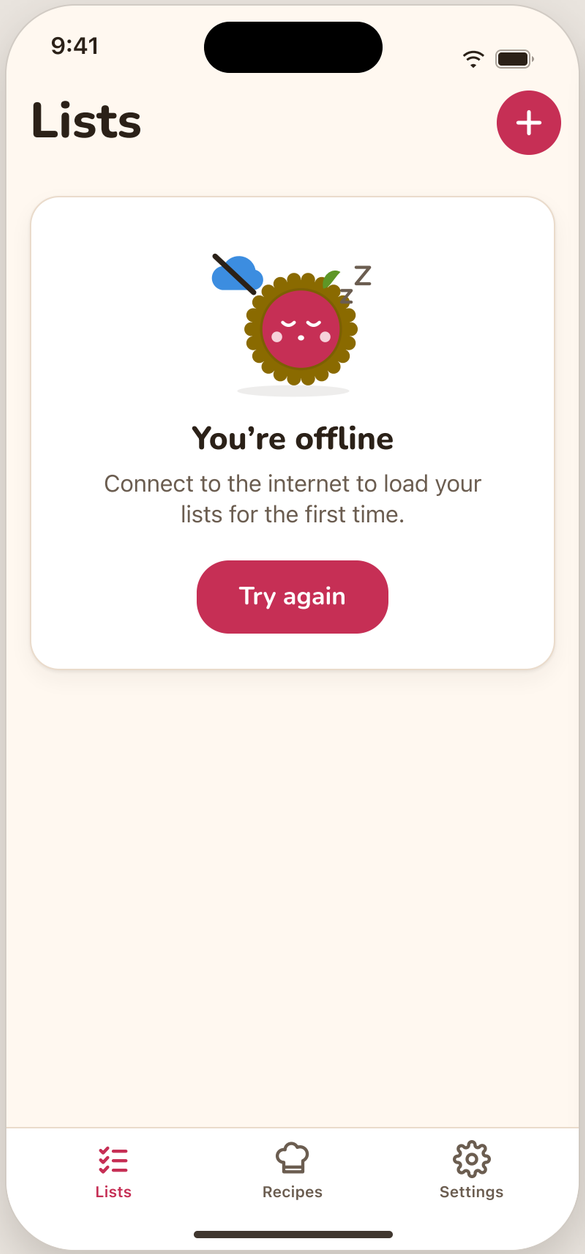
I9 Recipes / no recipes yet · Light



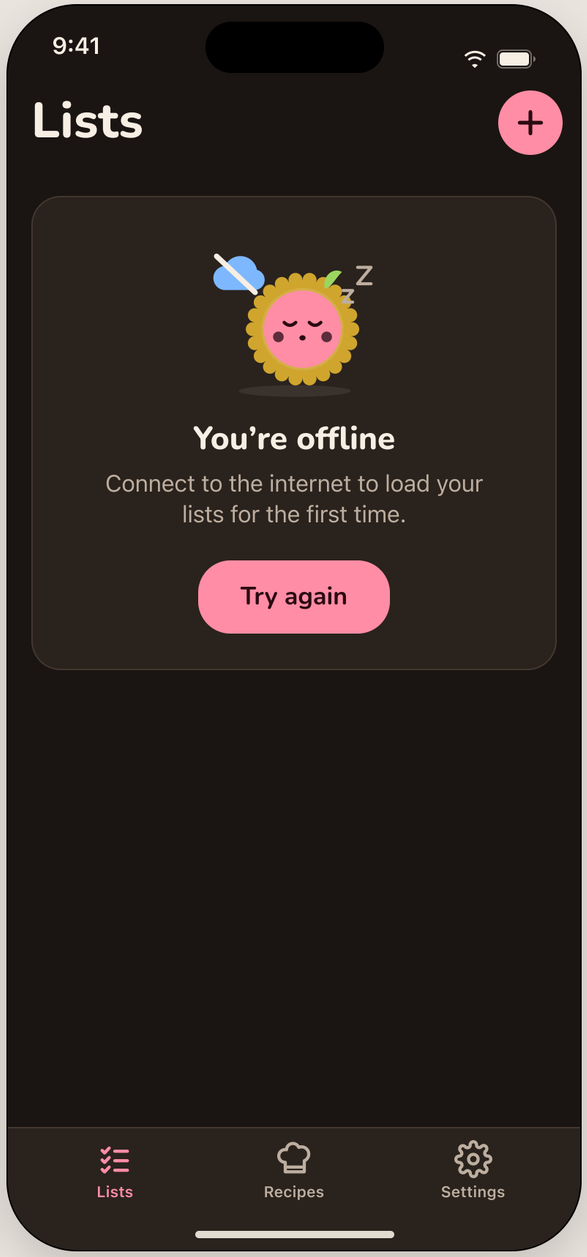
I9 Recipes / no recipes yet · Dark

iPhone · Offline and error

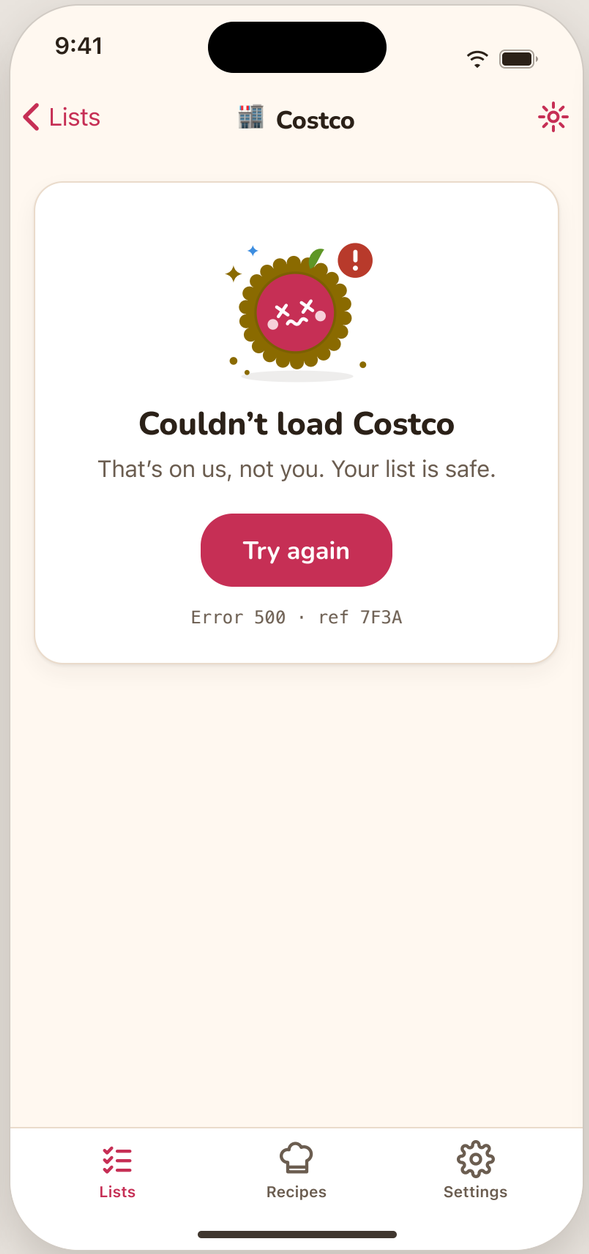
Offline full-screen only when nothing is cached (first launch). With data it is the IMP-16 banner. Error is a card with Try again and a small reference id; the add bar is absent because no list is loaded.



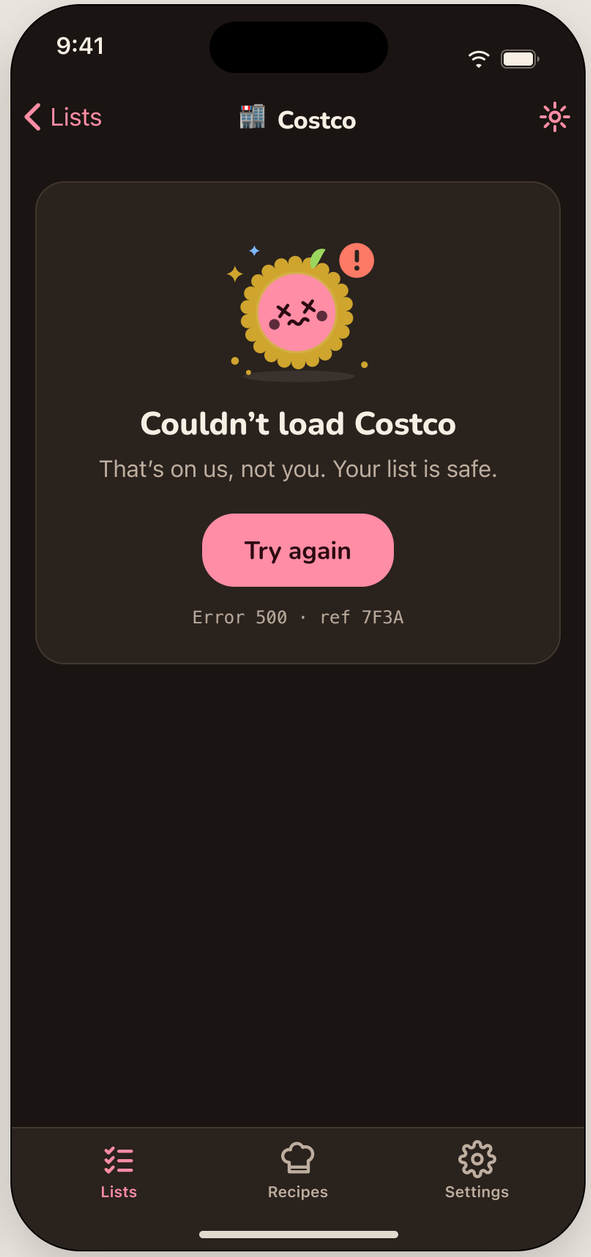
I1 Lists home / offline, nothing cached · Light



I1 Lists home / offline, nothing cached · Dark



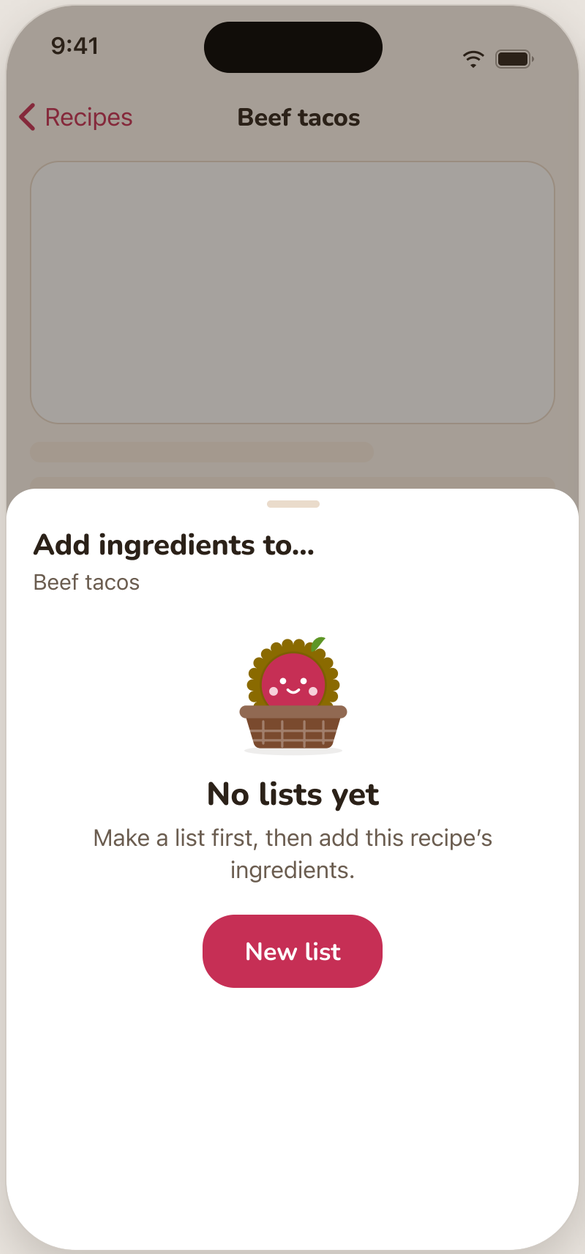
I4 List detail / load error · Light



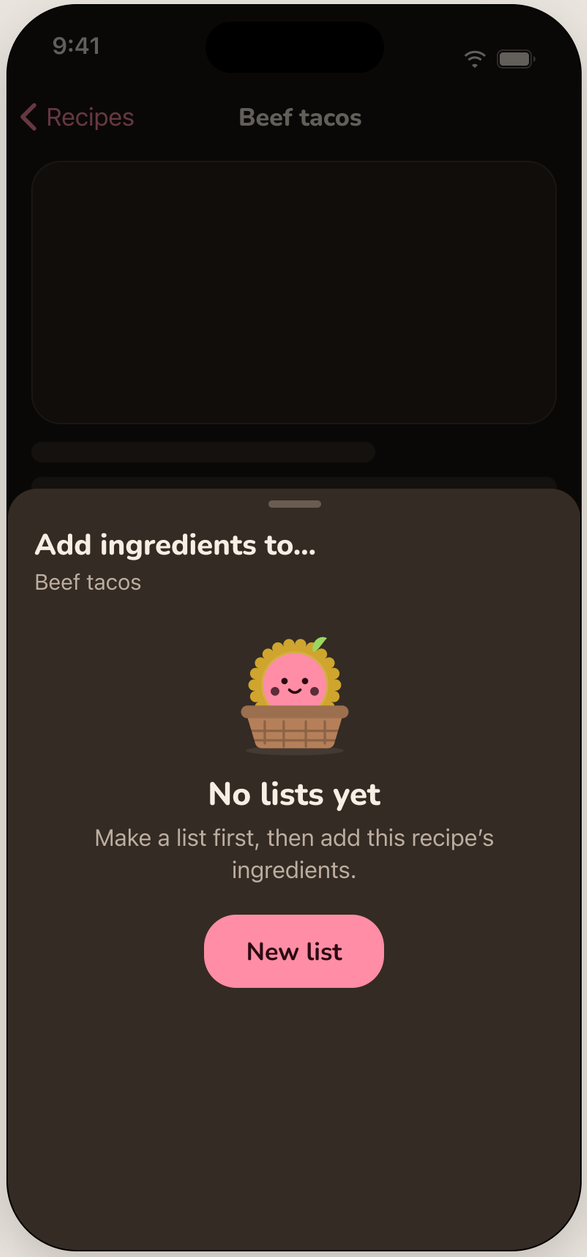
I4 List detail / load error · Dark

iPhone · Sheet shell and Dynamic Type

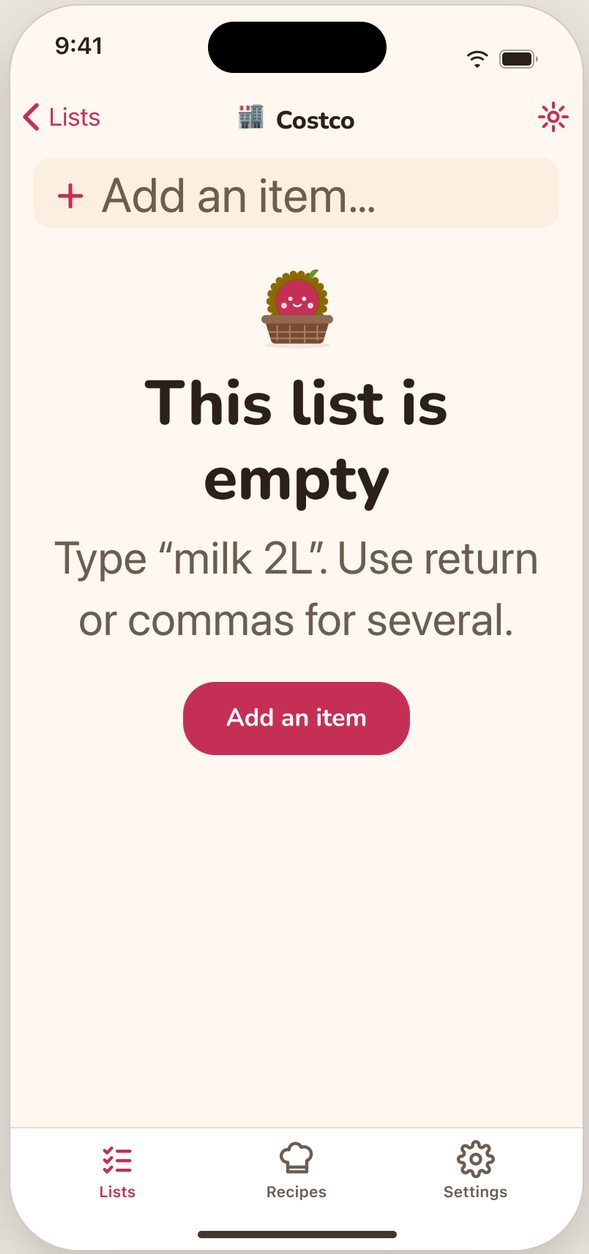
Sheet: add-to-list from a recipe when the family has no lists yet, compact pie (108). Right: at AX2 the pie drops to 72 wide, the headline wraps, and the button stays 50 pt high and reachable.



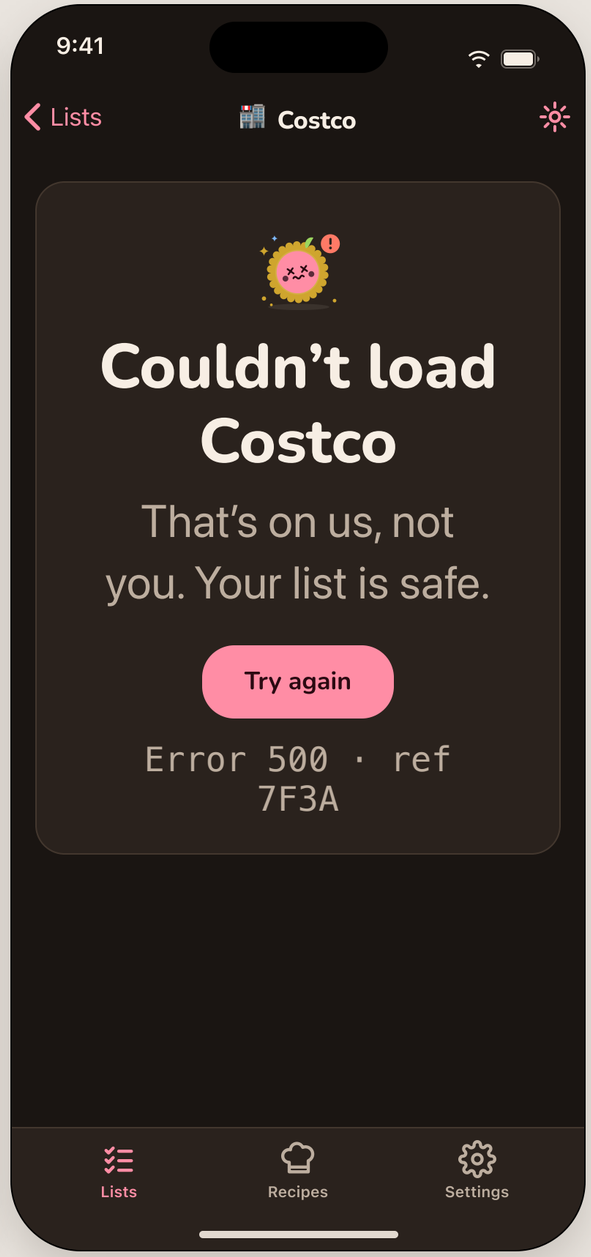
I10 Add to list sheet / no lists · Light



I10 Add to list sheet / no lists · Dark



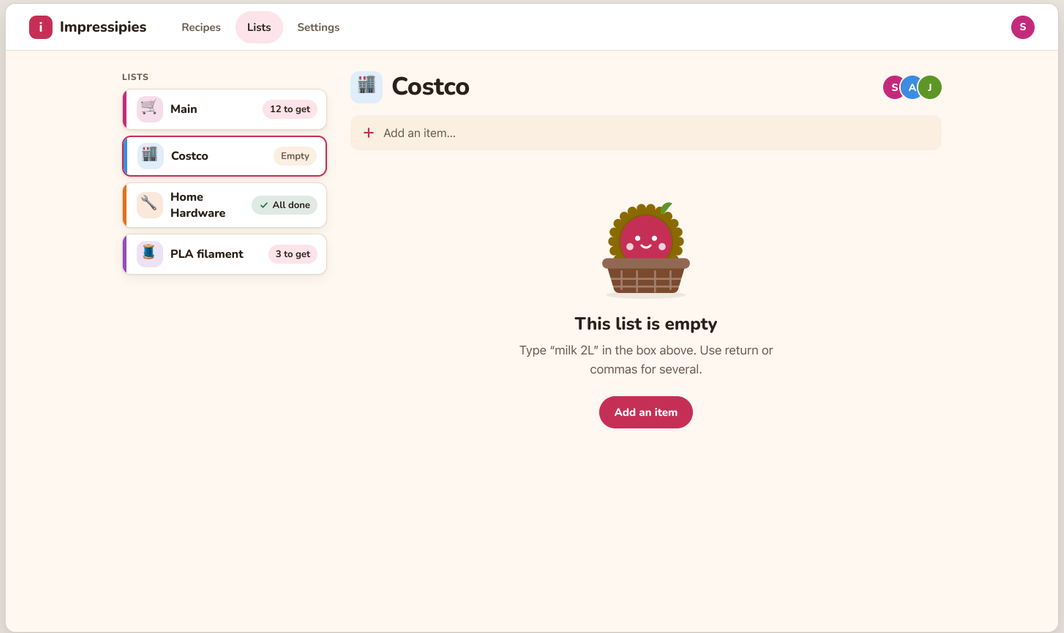
I4 List detail / empty · Light · AX2 (33)



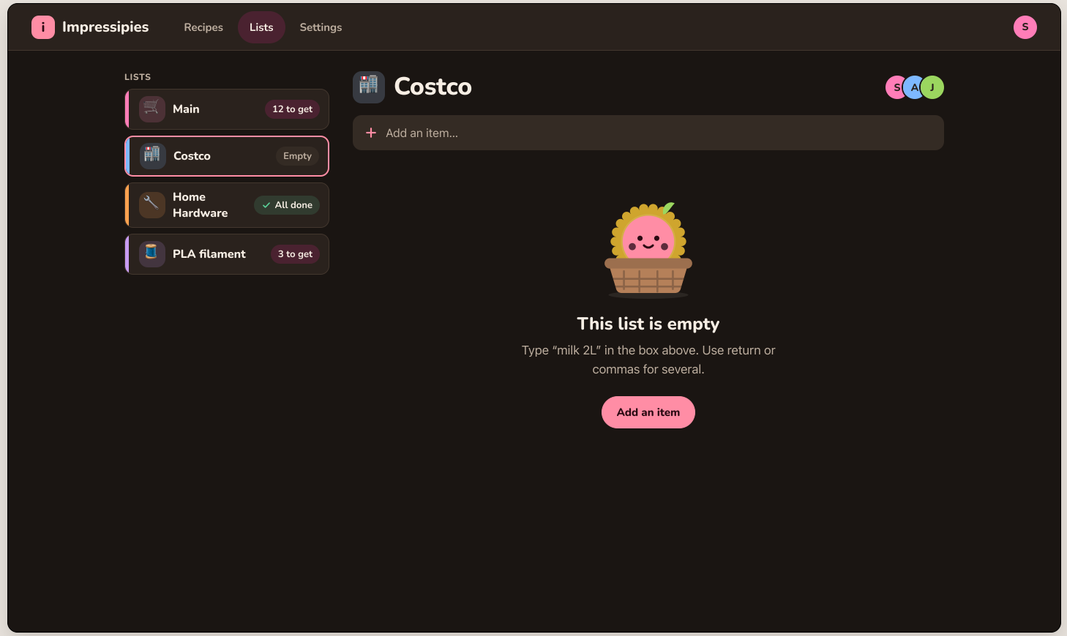
I4 List detail / load error · Dark · AX2 (33)

Web · Empty list

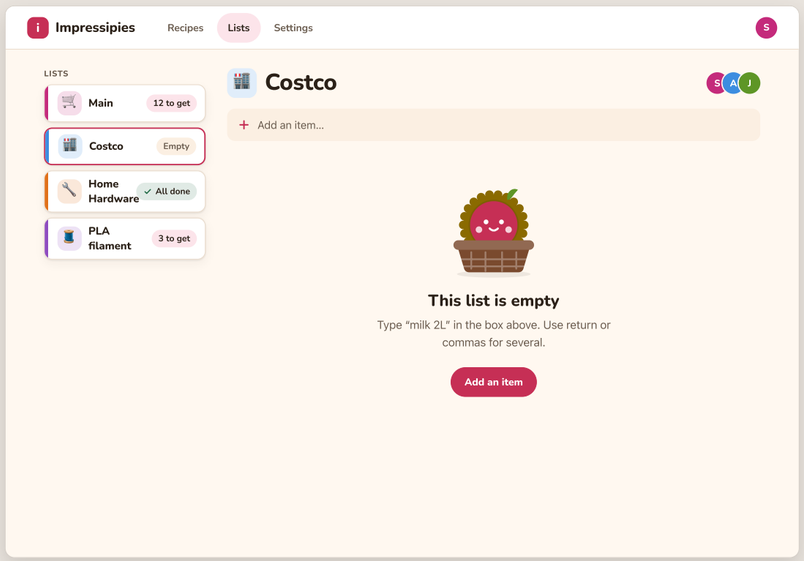
Selected list shows the add box and the pie below it. The list column keeps its counts; Costco reads “Empty”. Same layout at tablet; the phone is the iPhone layout in a 360 viewport.



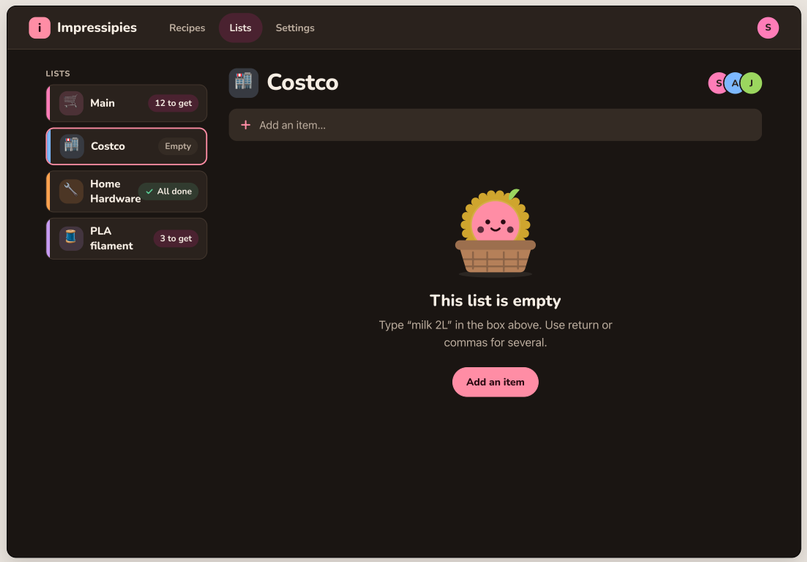
W6 Lists and list detail / empty list, desktop 1440 · Light



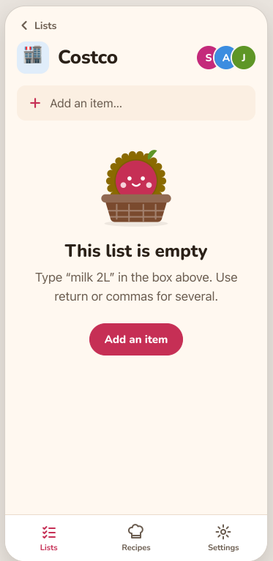
W6 Lists and list detail / empty list, desktop 1440 · Dark



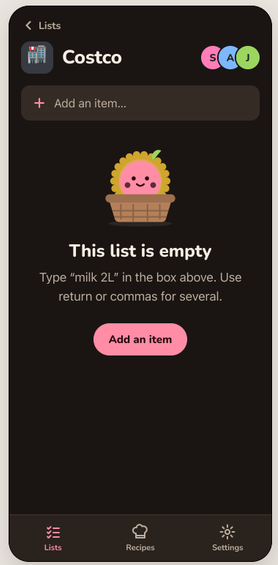
W6 Lists and list detail / empty list, tablet 1180 · Light



W6 Lists and list detail / empty list, tablet 1180 · Dark



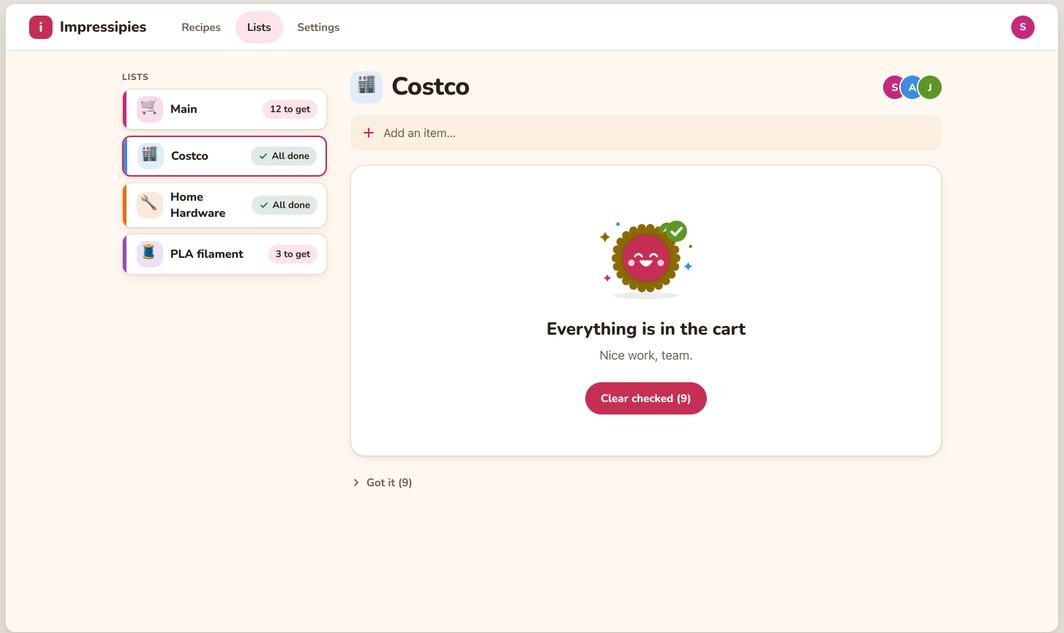
W6 Lists and list detail / 360 · Light



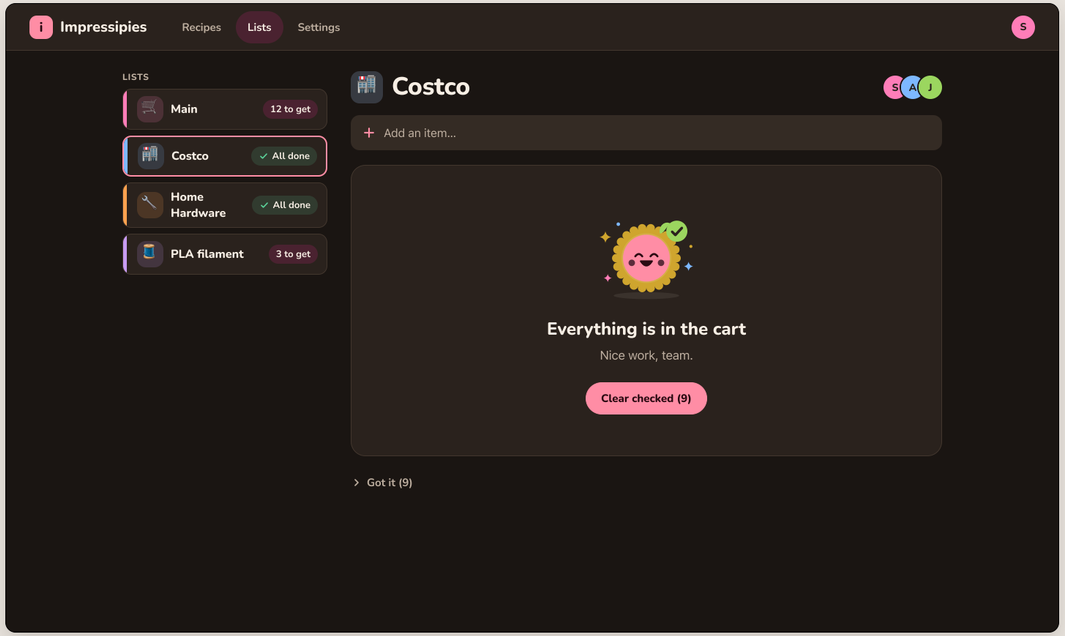
W6 Lists and list detail / 360 · Dark

Web · All done

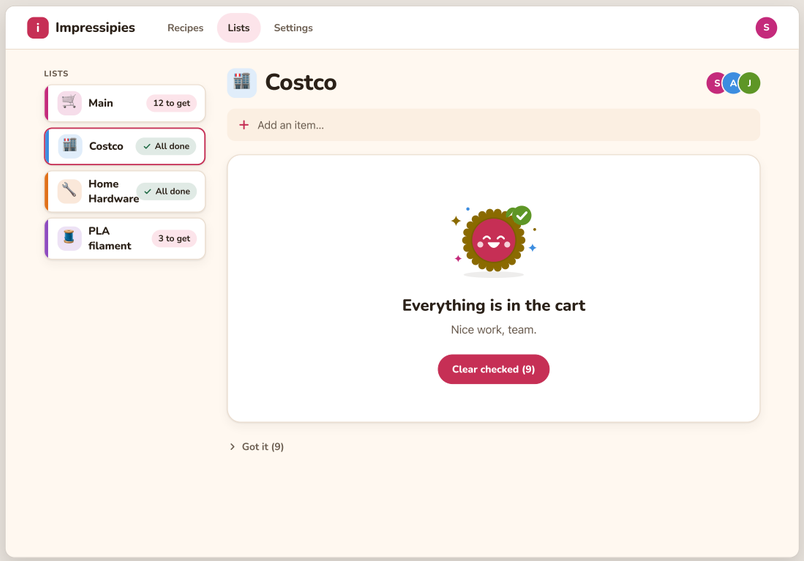
Card shell with a happy pie and Clear checked as the action. Got it stays collapsed beneath. The list column shows “All done” in the success pill, as on the iPhone.



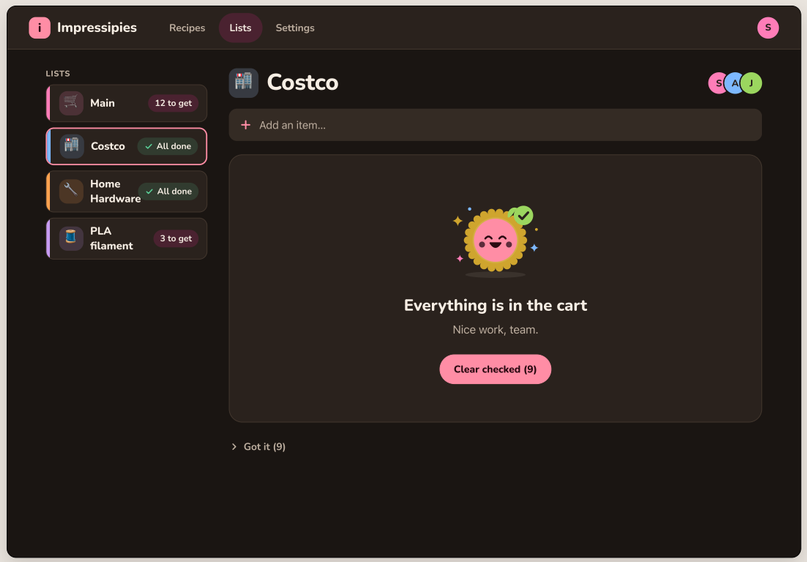
W6 Lists and list detail / all done, desktop 1440 · Light



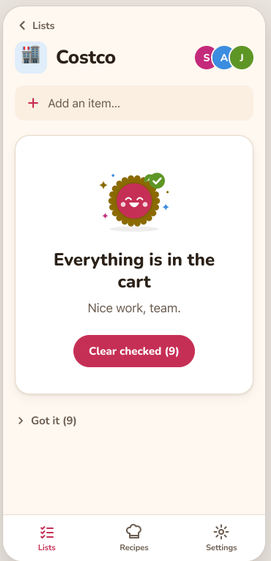
W6 Lists and list detail / all done, desktop 1440 · Dark



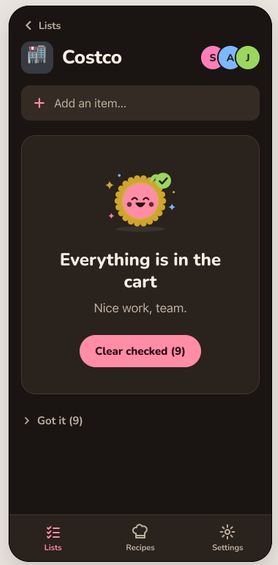
W6 Lists and list detail / all done, tablet 1180 · Light



W6 Lists and list detail / all done, tablet 1180 · Dark



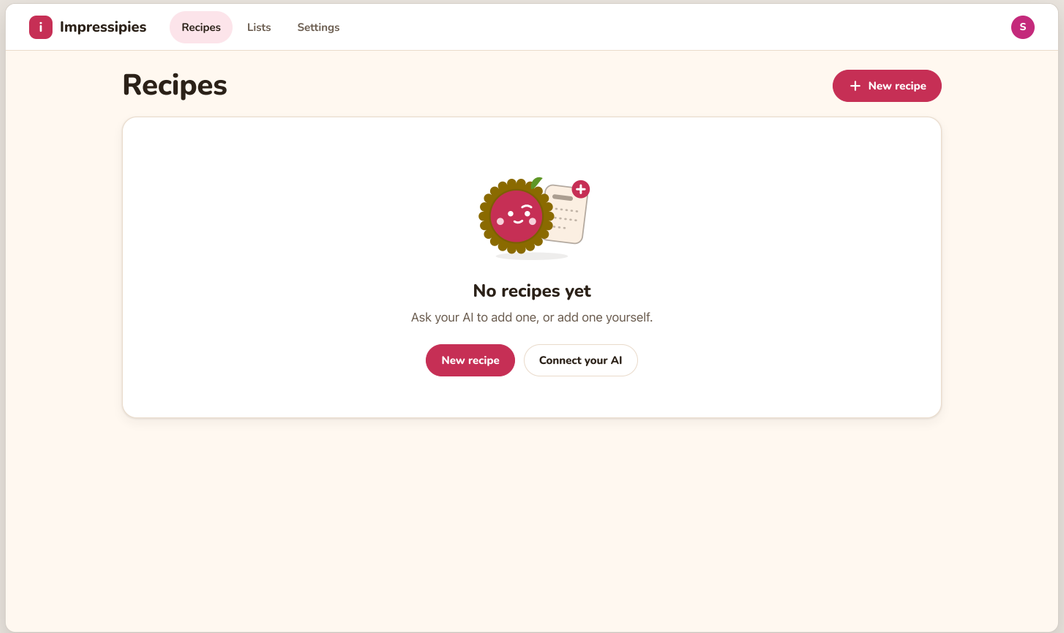
W6 Lists and list detail / 360 · Light



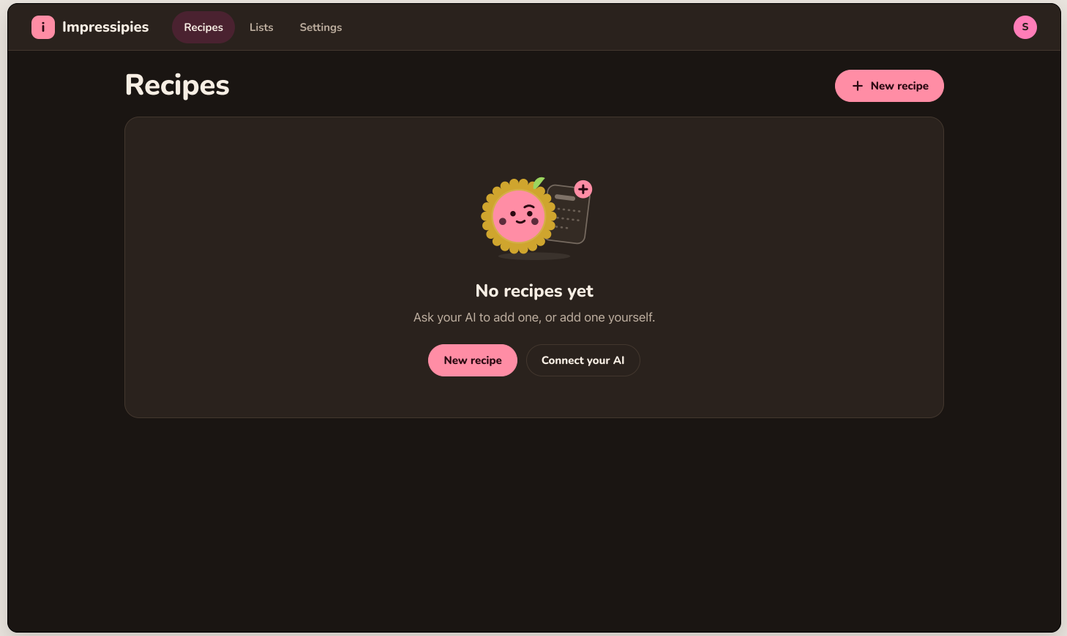
W6 Lists and list detail / 360 · Dark

Web · No recipes yet

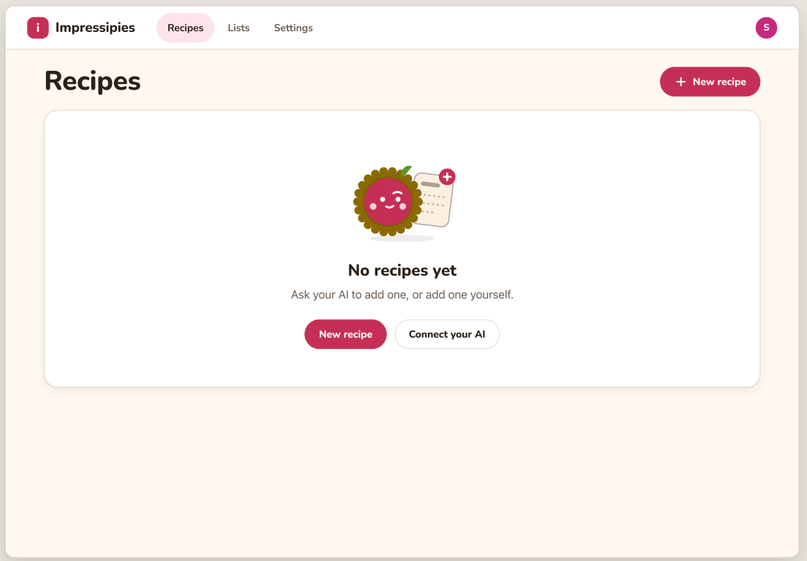
Matches the IMP-17 empty grid: New recipe stays top right and also lives in the card, with Connect your AI as the second route. Search and filters are hidden until a recipe exists.



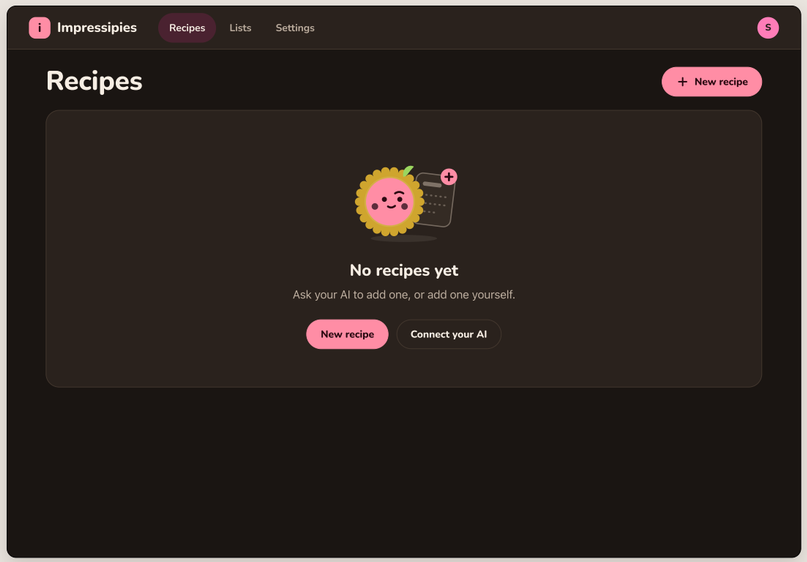
W1 Recipe grid / no recipes yet, desktop 1440 · Light



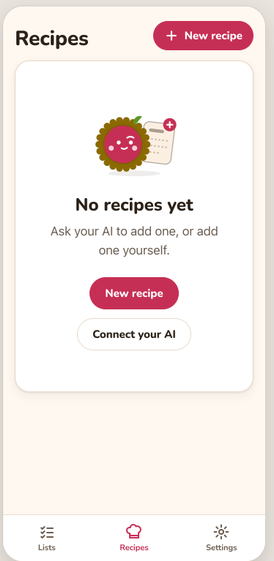
W1 Recipe grid / no recipes yet, desktop 1440 · Dark



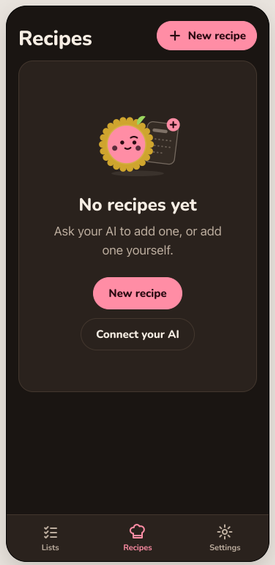
W1 Recipe grid / no recipes yet, tablet 1180 · Light



W1 Recipe grid / no recipes yet, tablet 1180 · Dark



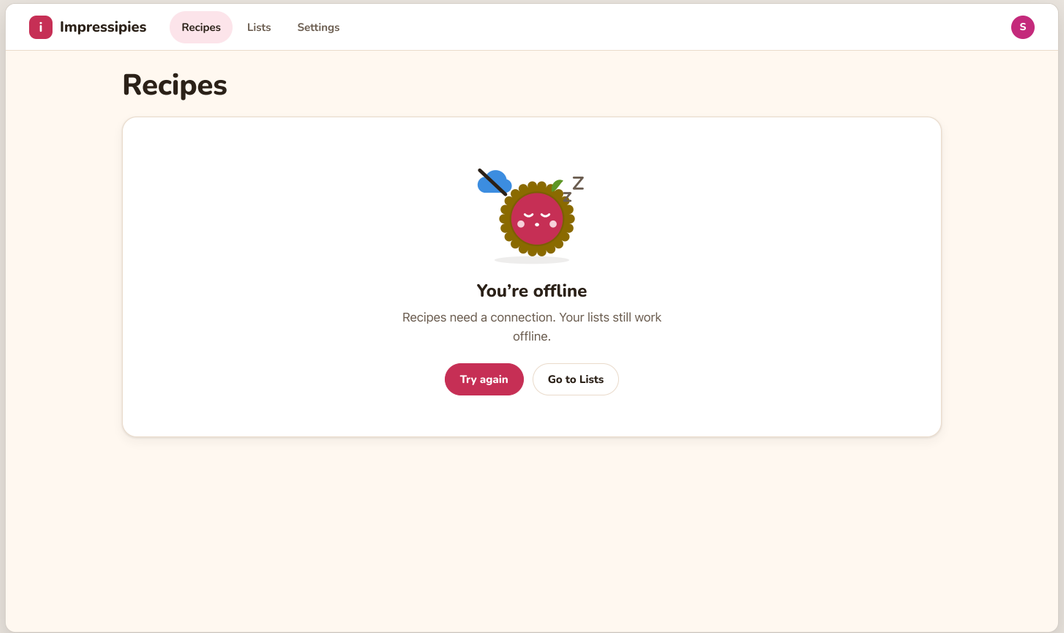
W1 Recipe grid / 360 · Light



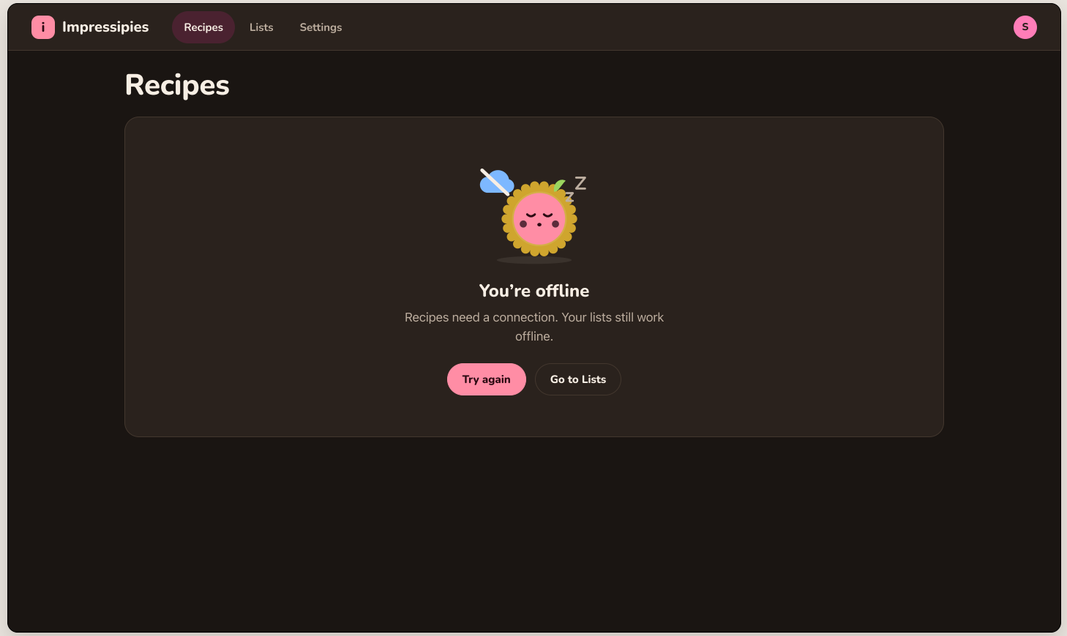
W1 Recipe grid / 360 · Dark

Web · Offline, nothing cached

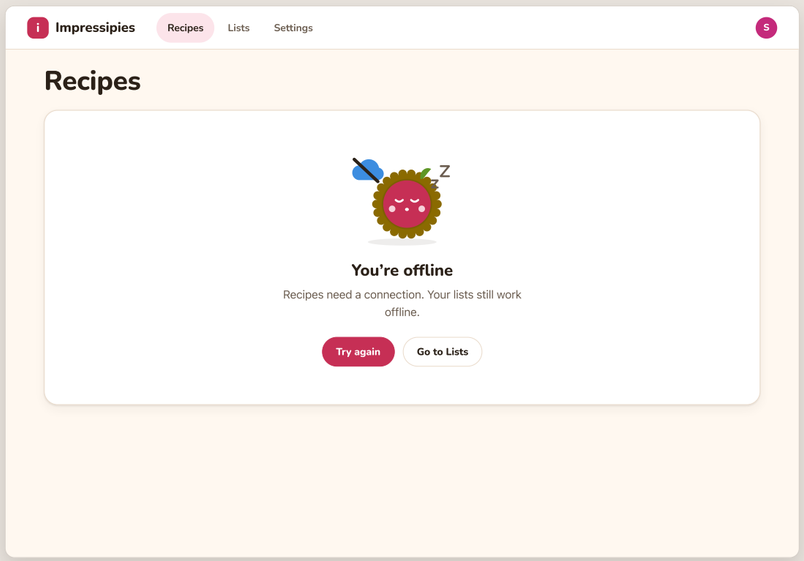
Recipes load on demand, so with no connection and no cache the grid becomes this card. Lists still work offline, so the secondary action goes there.



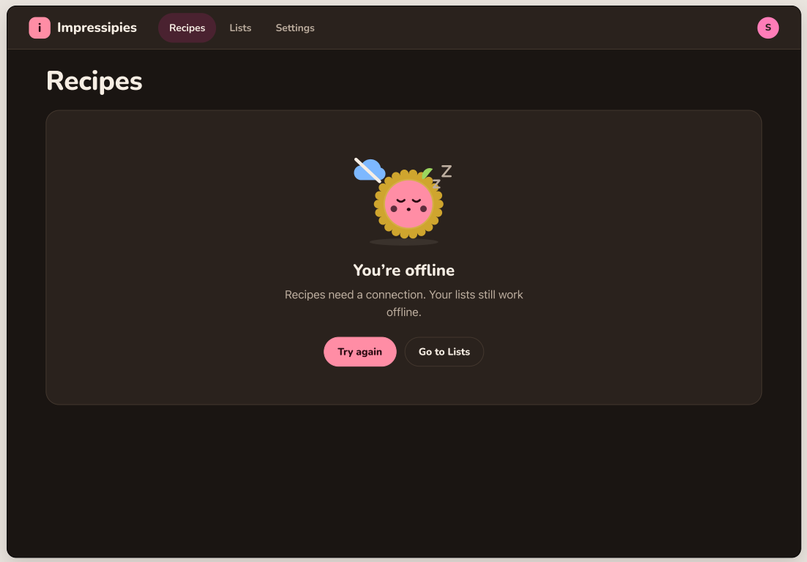
W1 Recipe grid / offline, nothing cached, desktop 1440 · Light



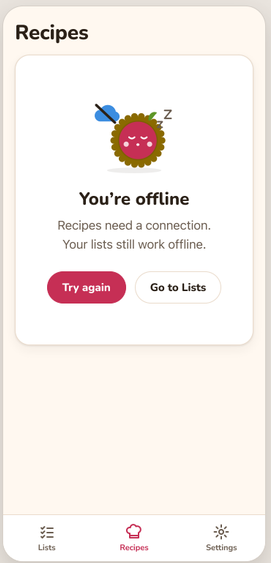
W1 Recipe grid / offline, nothing cached, desktop 1440 · Dark



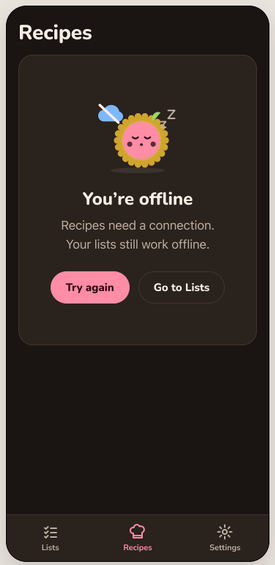
W1 Recipe grid / offline, nothing cached, tablet 1180 · Light



W1 Recipe grid / offline, nothing cached, tablet 1180 · Dark



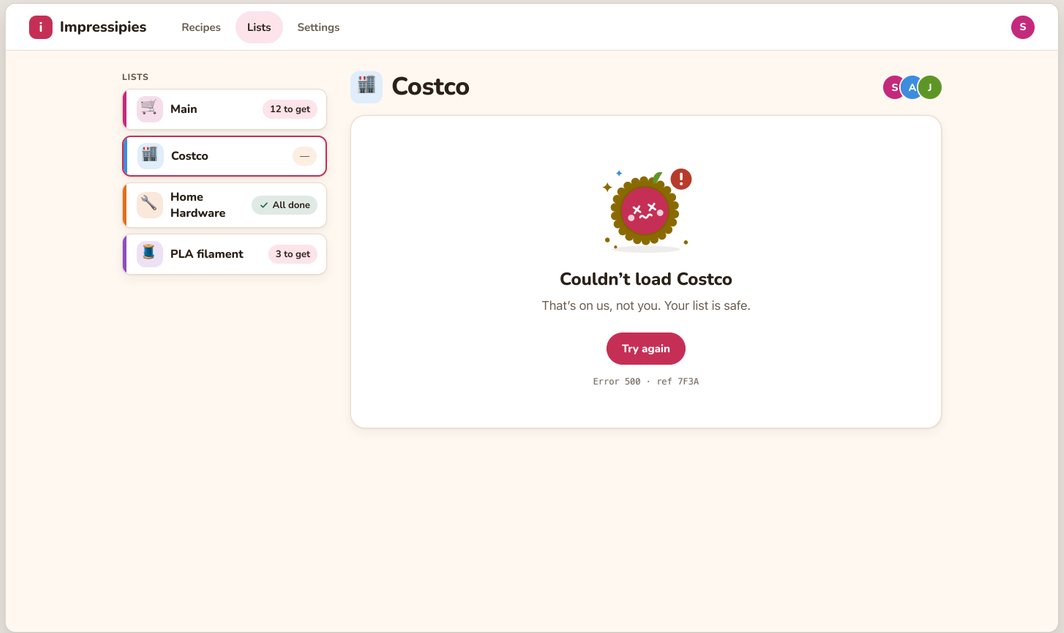
W1 Recipe grid / 360 · Light



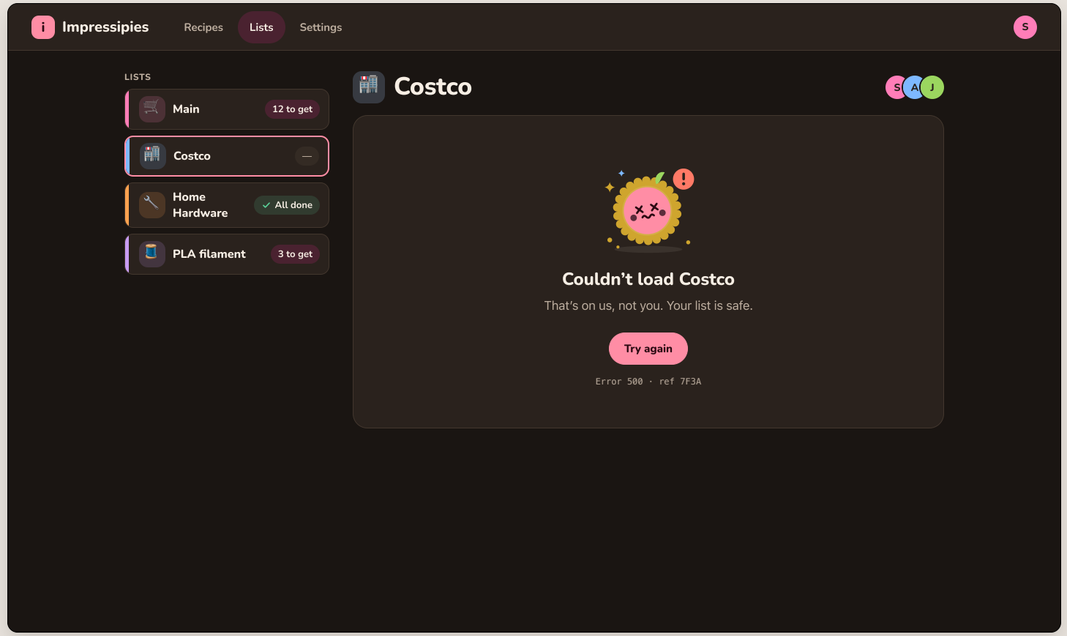
W1 Recipe grid / 360 · Dark

Web · Load error

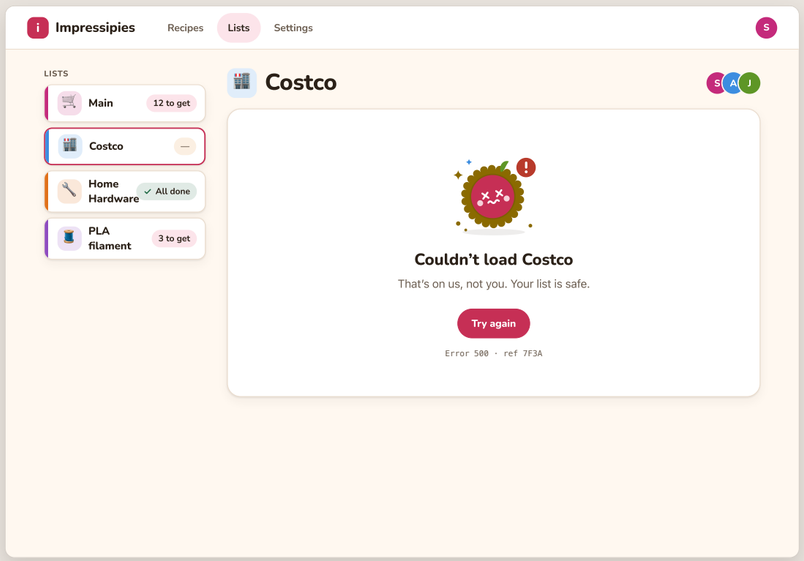
The list column still renders (it is cached); only the selected list failed. Try again retries just that request. The add box is absent.



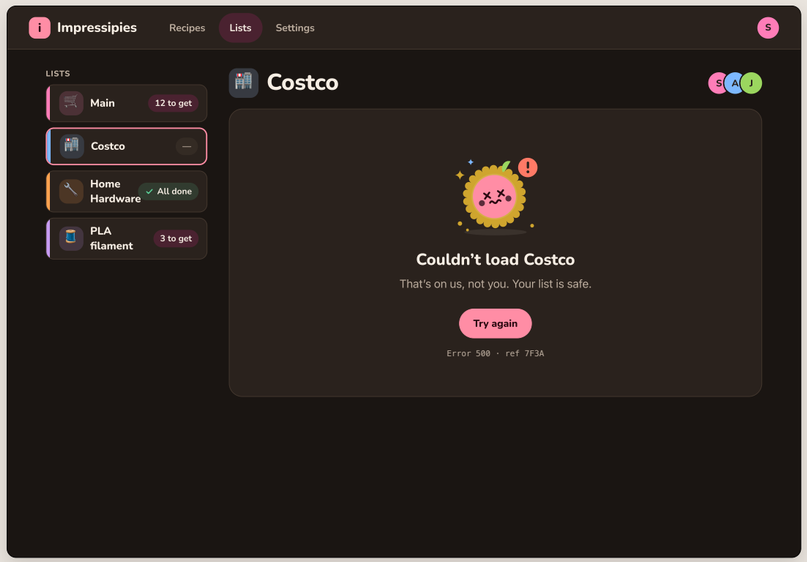
W6 List detail / error loading, desktop 1440 · Light



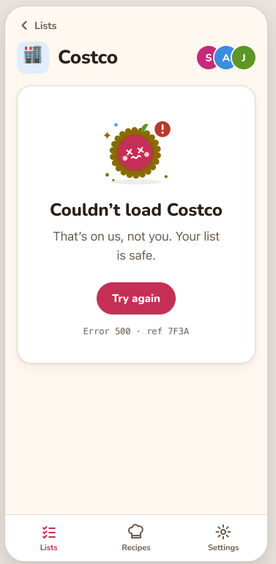
W6 List detail / error loading, desktop 1440 · Dark



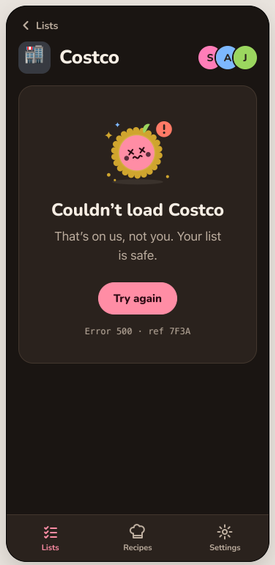
W6 List detail / error loading, tablet 1180 · Light



W6 List detail / error loading, tablet 1180 · Dark



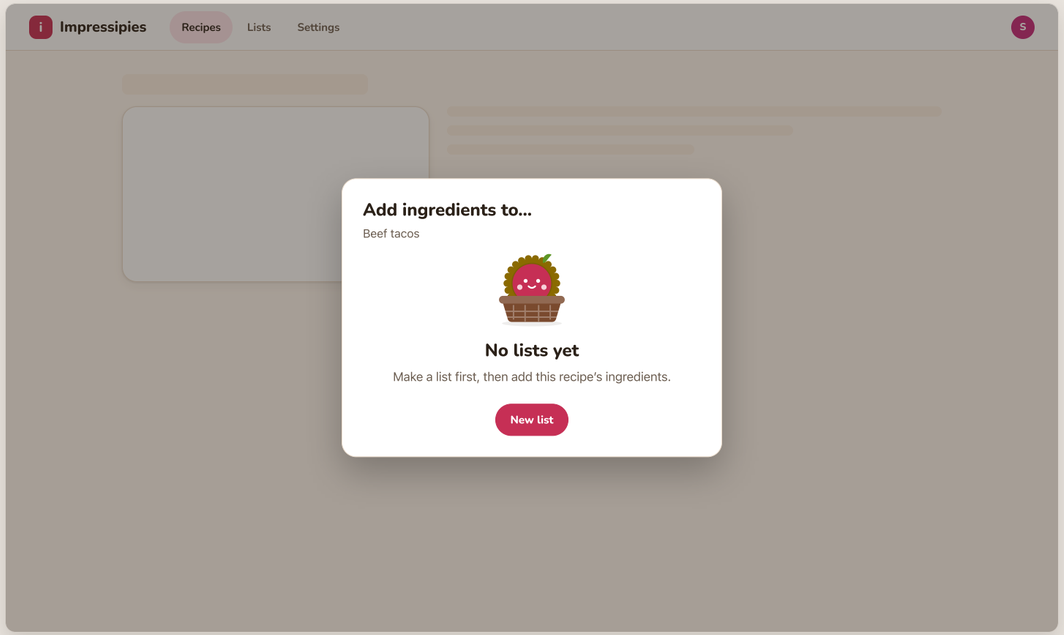
W6 List detail / 360 · Light



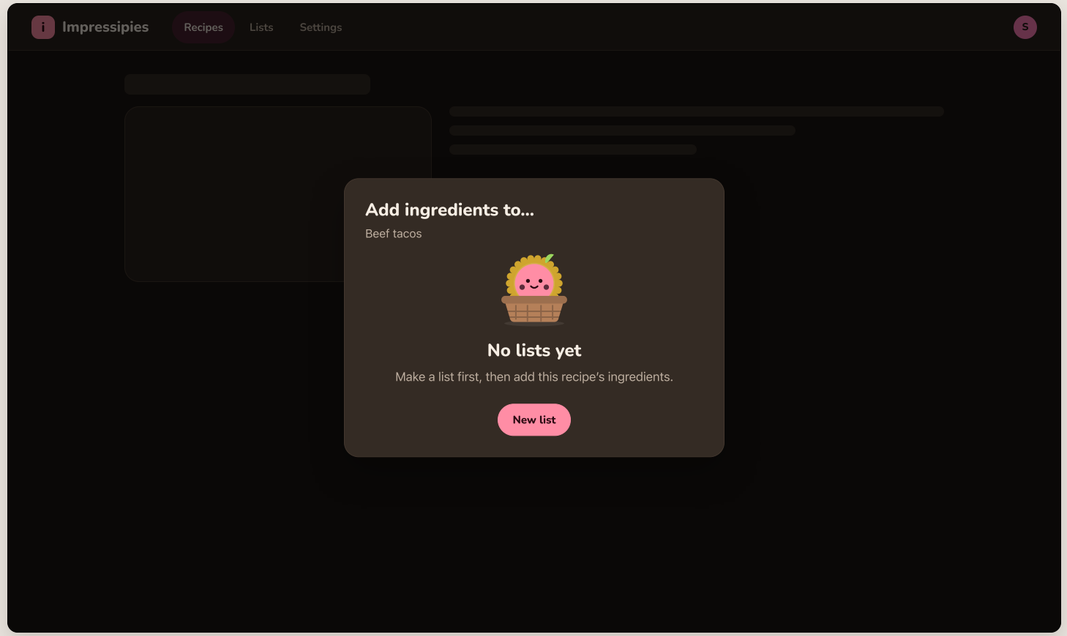
W6 List detail / 360 · Dark

Web · Sheet shell: add ingredients with no lists

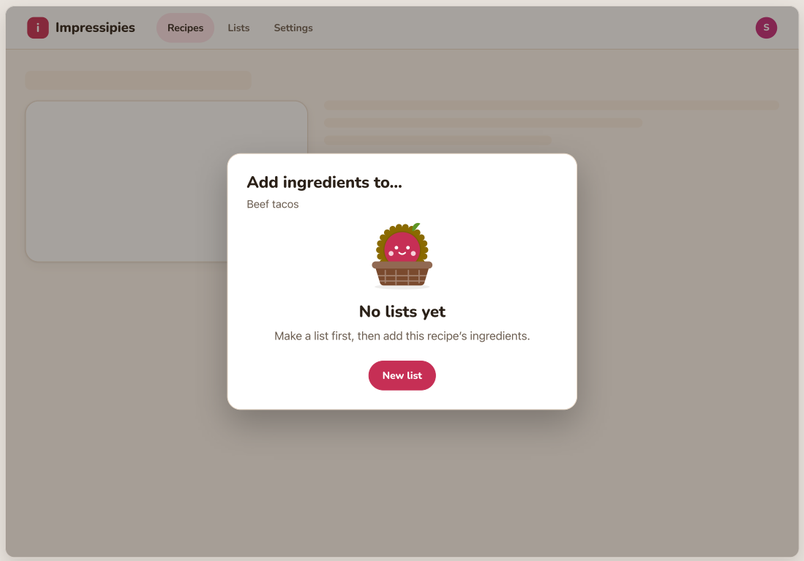
The IMP-17 add-to-list dialog (modal at desktop and tablet, bottom sheet on a phone) when the family has no lists. One action, New list, then back to the dialog with the ingredients still ticked.



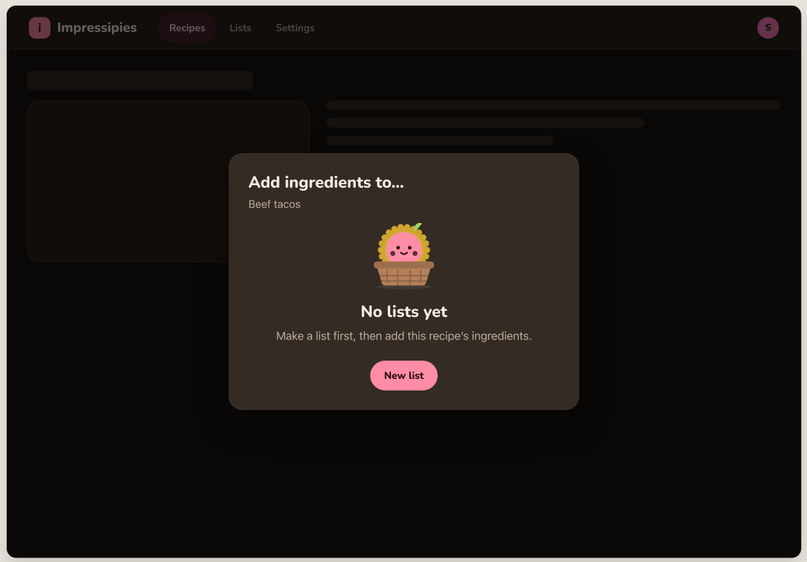
W3 Add-to-list dialog / no lists, desktop 1440 · Light



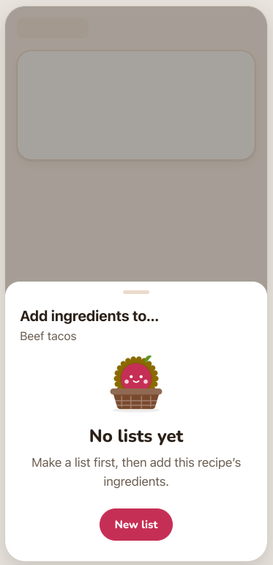
W3 Add-to-list dialog / no lists, desktop 1440 · Dark



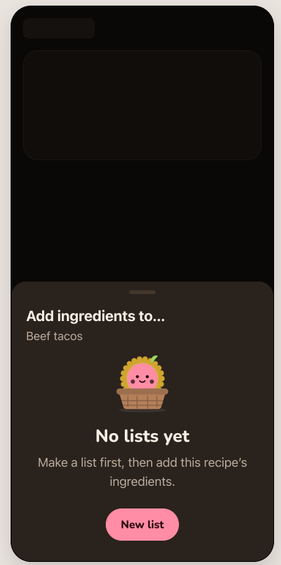
W3 Add-to-list dialog / no lists, tablet 1180 · Light



W3 Add-to-list dialog / no lists, tablet 1180 · Dark



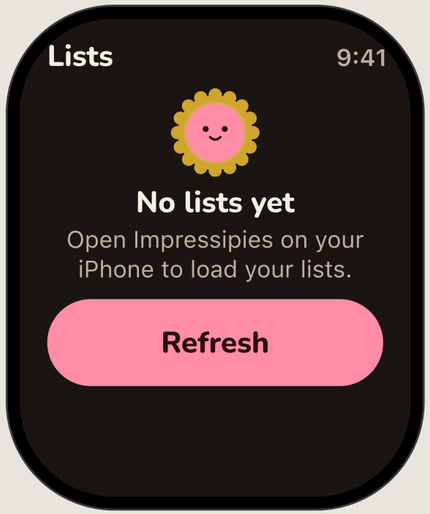
W3 Add-to-list sheet / 360 · Light



W3 Add-to-list sheet / 360 · Dark

Apple Watch · Empty states

Always dark. 41, 45 and 49 mm. System fonts and the dark token values only; the pie is a 40 to 50 pt glyph with no props. Rows and buttons keep a 44 pt target. No recipes on the watch, so “No recipes yet” does not apply; the Add item row stays on top wherever a list is loaded.



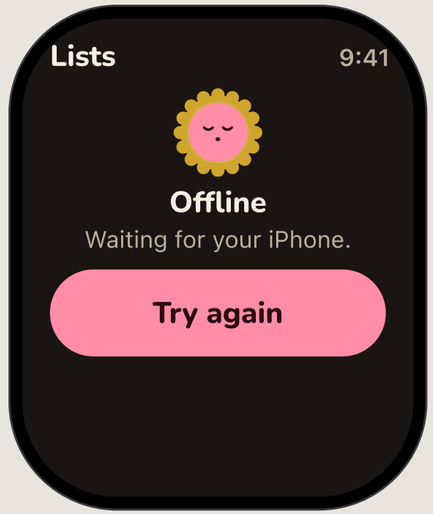
K1 List picker / no lists yet (first launch) · Dark · 45 mm



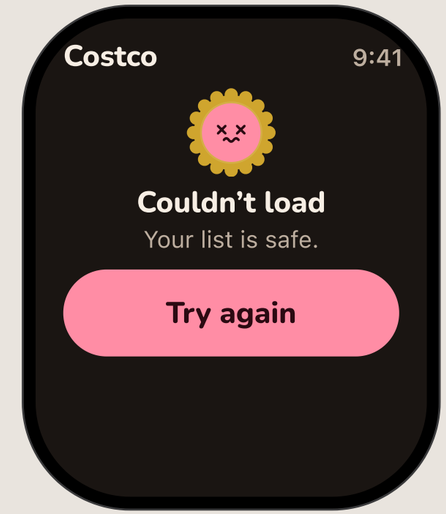
K2 List detail / empty · Dark · 45 mm



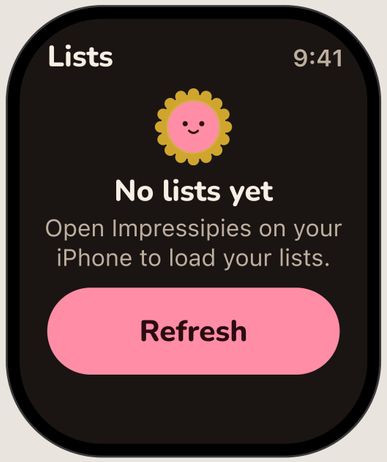
K2 List detail / all done · Dark · 45 mm



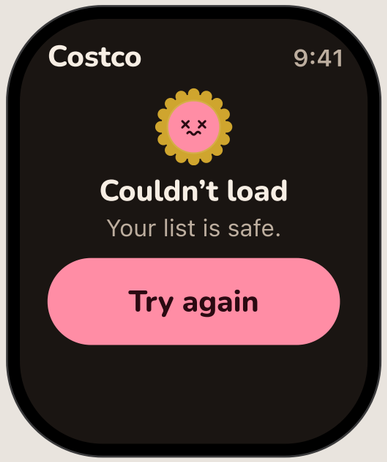
K4 List picker / offline, nothing cached · Dark · 45 mm



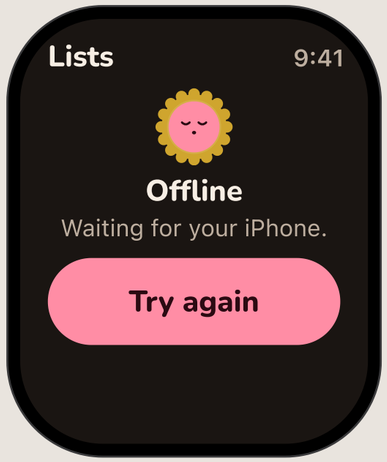
K2 List detail / load error · Dark · 45 mm



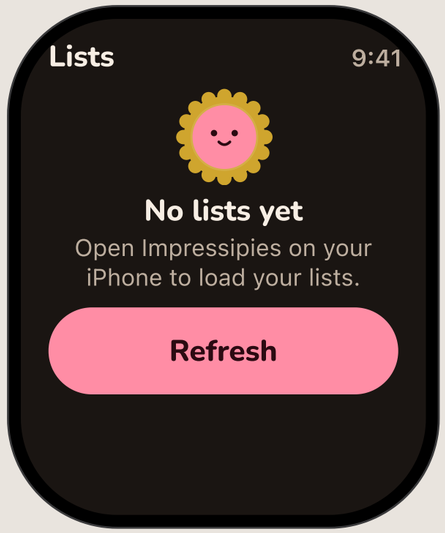
K1 List picker / no lists yet · Dark · 41 mm



K2 List detail / load error · Dark · 41 mm



K4 List picker / offline · Dark · 41 mm



K1 List picker / no lists yet · Dark · 49 mm



K2 List detail / all done · Dark · 49 mm

Open questions

Nothing here changes the IMP-14 tokens or IMP-15 components. These are the calls this ticket made that someone else may want to overrule.

Decide

- **Empty list has a pie after all.** IMP-16 chose no illustration on the empty list so the add field stays prominent. Here the pie sits below the add bar. Watch it in IMP-12: do people still find the add bar unaided? Dropping the art is one flag.
- **Decorative or labelled?** Labels are specified. If VoiceOver users find “pie peeking out of an empty basket” noisy, mark the art decorative on empty list and all done and keep it on offline and error.
- **No semantic colours in artwork.** Error uses tomato, offline sky, done leaf, because the brief limits art to category colours. Tomato (`#B83A2B`) and danger (`#B3261E`) are close; confirm that is fine.
- **iPhone no-recipes action.** “Open on the web” assumes iPhone is read and cook only (IMP-11, I9). Needs a link target, or the action becomes “Connect your AI” if that ships on iPhone.
- **Web offline.** Assumes recipes are not cached for offline. If they are, the offline card only shows before the first load.

Check on devices

- Glyph legibility at 40 pt on a 41 mm watch (simulated here only).
- Light-mode sky (3.1:1) and leaf (3.2:1) shapes on `surface-2` in sunlight; they carry no meaning alone, so this is a polish check.
- AX2 layout on a real iPhone SE size class; the card must scroll, not clip.
- The pink filling in dark mode (`#FF8DA5`) is bright. If it glows too much next to the dark card, drop the filling to 90% opacity.
- **Pie legibility.** The scalloped crust can read as a flower at 32 to 40 pt. If testing says so, add the lattice strip option (two crust-coloured bars across the filling) to the small sizes.
- PDF fonts: Nunito loaded from Google Fonts; the app uses SF Pro Rounded on Apple.

Copy and scope added

- New copy not in the briefs: “This list is empty”, “Nothing to get”, “That’s on us, not you. Your list is safe.”, “Error 500 · ref 7F3A”, “Make a list first, then add this recipe’s ingredients.”, “Recipes need a connection. Your lists still work offline.”
- Added the add-to-list sheet and dialog with no lists, which is a sheet-shell use of the same scene. Cheap to drop.
- Reference id and a “copy details” action for errors are not designed; the id is shown as text only.
- Not covered: validation errors, search with no results (IMP-17 has a text card), delete-category confirm, loading skeletons, Smart Stack and complications (IMP-20).
- Idle motion (blink, steam) is left to IMP-18. Groups carry ids so it can target them.
- Mascot name: none chosen.

Handoff: exporting the SVGs for the apps

The single source is `designs/imp-19/index.html`: `pie()`, SCENES and COPY. Do not redraw in another tool; generate from it.

Files to produce

- 5 scenes × 2 appearances: `illo-empty-list-light.svg`, `-dark.svg`, then `all-done`, `no-recipes`, `offline`, `error`. "No lists yet" reuses empty-list.
- 5 mascot faces × 2: `pie-hello`, `happy`, `sleepy`, `dizzy`, `curious`, and the 124-wide glyph set `pie-mini-*` for watch.
- Scenes: `viewBox="0 0 200 170"`. Mascot: `36 18 128 140`. Glyph: `38 28 124 124`. No width or height attribute.
- Each file is flat: paths, circles, rects, ellipses and groups with stable ids `pie crust filling face prop sparkle`. No text, filters, gradients, masks, clip-paths or CSS.
- Opacity only through `fill-opacity` / `stroke-opacity`. Strokes use round caps and joins.

Per platform

- **Web:** inline SVG in a component (`<Illustration name="error" />`), not `<img>`, with colours as `var(--color-cat-mustard)` etc. The IMP-14 theme attribute recolours it; no dark file. `role="img"` and `aria-label` from `COPY`; `aria-hidden` if the open question lands on decorative.
- **iOS:** one Image Set per illustration in `Illustrations.xcassets`, appearances Any and Dark, Preserve Vector Data on, Render As Original, Scales Single. Names `Illustration/EmptyList` and so on. Hex values are resolved from the IMP-14 Color Sets at export time, not hand-picked. Label via `.accessibilityLabel`.
- **watchOS:** dark files only, in the watch asset catalog, and only the glyph set (`pie-mini-*`); the scenes are not used on the watch.
- **Android or email:** not in scope.

How to generate

- Add a small Node script in the build tickets that evaluates the generators, substitutes each `var(--name)` with the light or dark hex from the IMP-14 table, and writes the files above. Run it in CI so exports never drift from tokens.
- For web, the same script outputs the unresolved `var(--color-*)` version, renaming `--mustard` to `--color-cat-mustard`, `--accent` to `--color-accent` and so on.
- Check after export: opens in Preview and Chrome, SwiftUI `Image("…")` renders in light and dark previews, file size under 4 KB each, contrast of every shape at least 3:1 against `bg`.
- Text version of these decisions is on the Notion Designs page beside the PDF.
- Dependent: IMP-18 (idle motion), IMP-20 (watch, Smart Stack), build tickets for list, recipe and sync states.